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Exploring 17th and 18th century Frisian

Syntactic and morphological observations

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0. Introduction

0.1. About this work

This work is a collection of syntactic and morphological observations on the Frisian language of the 17th and 18th centuries. This period used to be called Middle Frisian, but these centuries were felt to be too late for this designation to apply. The term Early Modern Frisian has been proposed, but that is quite a mouthful, so here the more exact designation has been preferred: 17th and 18th century Frisian, abbreviated as Frisian^{17&18}.

The observations presented here were collected as I read through all Frisian texts of this period for my two anthologies of Frisian literature (Hoekstra 2013 and 2015). The phenomena which I recorded are all special in the sense that they involve differences between Modern Frisian and Frisian^{17&18}. The differences chiefly involve syntax and morphology, in that order. For an introductory grammar of Modern Frisian, see Tiersma (1999). For more advanced grammatical information, see Taalportaal.org>Frisian.

If the Dutch language of these centuries is already severely understudied, one can imagine how much worse this is for a minority language like Frisian. And to be fair, not much Frisian was written in these two centuries. Of course, the baroque works of Gysbert Japicx stands out in the 17th century. The 18th century saw the publication of the phenomenally low comedy *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft* of 1701, which contains Frisian which is incredibly close to the language as it must have been spoken. The second half of the century saw the publication of an excellent moral satirical comedy: *It Libben fan Aagtje IJsbrants*. The total Frisian output of these two centuries amounts to roughly a million words. In order to facilitate the further study of Middle Frisian, this introduction contains some useful references providing the incipient student of Frisian^{17&18} with helpful information about resources useful for further research, such as Van der Kuip's (~2005) unrivalled course on *Midfrysk* and the Language Corpus Frisian (<https://frisian.eu/corpus-frontend/frysk/search/>).

The lay-out of the present work is quite simple. The observations are classified by syntactic category. The relevant example sentences are given, glossed, translated and it is briefly explained how these examples contrast with Modern Frisian. The first draft of this work was written in Frisian, but the present version was rewritten in English, because Frisian studies need all the help they can get, and who knows whether this work catches somebody's fancy. After all, many foreigners have made impressive contributions to the study of Frisian in space and time, that is, to the study of the three Frisian languages synchronically and diachronically. Among them are Japanese, Italians, Swedes, Belgians, Englishmen, Germans, Americans, Canadians, Norwegians and Frenchmen, not to mention native speakers of Dutch who acquired or studied the Frisian language.

The Fryske Akademy serves as a focal point for Frisian studies. In addition, there are many researchers scattered across various universities and institutes who concern themselves with Frisian studies on a regular or irregular basis. I hope that Frisian researchers may profit from this work, and that laymen are inspired to read for themselves the sources of the example sentences.

0.2. Practical remarks

Some practical remarks are in order. Examples of Frisian^{17&18} are preceded by a standardized reference to their source. This source consists of the year of publication, followed by the titel, followed by the author (if the author is known).

Abbreviations. The following abbreviations have been used:

DcP Discourse Particle: The term discourse particle is used for adverbs like German *mal* in *Kom mal her* ‘Come here’. They provide shades of meaning which have no equivalent in English, but Dutch and Frisian are like German in this respect.

ARB The arbitrary pronoun *men* or *me*.

DEM Demonstrative pronoun, often used as topic pronoun

F^{17&18} Frisian of the 17th and 18th centuries

GI Gerundial Infinitive

NPI Negative Polarity Item

OI Ordinary Infinitive

PI Partitive inflection on adjectives. Adjective are marked with -s, if they are used as partitives, as in: *wat moai-s* ‘something beautiful’.

PPI Positive Polarity Item

REF Reflexive pronoun

REL Relative pronoun

Spelling. It should be borne in mind that Frisian^{17&18} didn’t have a uniform spelling convention. Thus, example sentences may display different spellings of the same word. If Frisian^{17&18} words are cited in the running text, then they are spelled according to the spelling rules of ModF.

Example sentences are taken from a precursor of FC, from the present FC (Frisian Corpora:

<https://frisian.eu/corpus-frontend/frysk/search>) and from the literature. Examples are glossed and

translated. Lexical information on ModF (1900-present) can be found in the WFT (Wurdboek fan de

Fryske Taal [Dictionary of the Frisian Language]): <https://gtb.ivdnt.org/search/?owner=GTB>. For information on the grammar of Modern Frisian, see: <https://taalportaal.org/taalportaal/topic/>.

Sources of example sentences are given below them. Sources always have a format in which the first four digits constitute the year in which the source material was published. So the reader directly knows the approximate year from which the sentence stems. This is followed by the title of the source and its author, if known. Some references are given at the end of this text.

Finally, I would thank my colleagues Arjen Versloot, Bouke Slofstra, Frits van der Kuip, Hindrik Sijens, Oebele Vries, Pieter Duijff, Siebren Dyk and Willem Visser for valuable information on Frisian from various centuries and on the linguistic database which was in use at that time. This old linguistic database has been replaced by a modern successor available here: <https://frisian.eu/corpus-frontend/frysk/search>, see also: <https://frisian.eu/#nav-home> for other resources and applications. I would like to thank Eduard Drenth for bringing the old linguistic database up to date to the requirements of the present time.

0.3. Nooks and crannies: The study of older Frisian

Though the present study focuses on F^{17&18}, this section contains some programmatic remarks on the study of Frisian language and literature between 1500 and 1900, which is loosely referred here as Older Frisian (OrF), to distinguish it from Old Frisian (1100-1500).

Let me take my cue from the fact that there exists two short Latin texts on the grammar of Middle Frisian, dated to 1681, described in Bremmer (1992, see also Breuker 1989). These texts contain valuable specimina of OrF, as well as interesting grammatical remarks. This goes to show that the house of Frisian studies is a small house, but it has precious, interesting and rewarding nooks and crannies.

So now I have translated my random observations on F^{17&18} into English, and this immediately yields the longest existing text on F^{17&18} morphology and syntax. So little had been done, and most of that little was philological. So what would I advise to somebody who wants to continue research on the morphology and grammar of OrF? The best advice I can give is as follows:

- Read the original texts for fun, and mark interesting phenomena.
- Read the relevant articles on morphology and syntax of OrF.
- Learn how to use the *Frisian Corpora* application.
- Milk that cow, it will yield a wealth of qualitative and quantitative data.

In addition, there are some unfinished projects in OrF which should be brought to completion:

- Bouke Slofstra prepared a morphological database of OrF, in which morphologically complex words are divided up into simple words, prefixes and suffixes. This is an excellent instrument for morphological research, if it gets a user-friendly interface. The database has the form of an ACCESS database.
- Frits van der Kuip prepared an edition of the dictionary of Paulus Scheltema (aka *Paulus Liger* 'Paulus the Liar'). This work contains lots of interesting lexical observations and it deserves to be brought to completion.
- The old Linguistic Corpus of Middle Frisian contained a wealth of bibliographical-lexical information, which could be used for either an Etymological Dictionary (cf. Dyk's bibliography of lexical studies) or for a Dictionary of Frisian 1500-1800.

Allow me to close off with a quote from Gysbert Japicx.

Hjoed leit de wrâld omkeard

Today the world lies upside down

Yn klearre dûbelhertichheid

In sheer duplicity

Jou ús lân wer, Leav' Hear

Give our land back, Dear Lord,

De âlde rûne ienfâldichheid.

Its old round simplicity.

1. Complementiser, word order and related phenomena

1.1. The complementiser *dat* 'that'

1.1.1. Complementiser cliticisation and deletion in clauses of wishing

The complementiser *dat* 'that' may be omitted following the first person wish '*k woe* 'I wished'. The phenomenon has been discovered and analysed by Jarich Hoekstra (1993). Some examples are given below:

Ick woe ick it al hie.

I wished I it already had

'I wished I had it already'

(1639B, *Ansck in Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

En ik woe wol ris drinke, ik woe ik ien Zoepke hie.

and I wanted DcP DcP drink I wished I a drink had

'And I would like to drink, I wished I got a shot.'

(1778g, *De Prins kaam ta Boetenpost*, from Jarich Hoekstra 1993)

DcP stands for 'discourse particle'. Discourse particles are little words absent from English and hard to translate, if their semantic contribution can be expressed in English at all, but German and Dutch also have them. An example from German would be *mal* as in: *kom mal her* 'come here, please'.

Returning to Frisian^{17&18}, three observations can be made:

- The wish is first person.
- The complementiser is absent.
- The word order following the complementiser remains that of an embedded clause.

It is not unusual for Frisian that the complementiser is absent. This is frequently the case in spoken Frisian. But in those cases, the 'embedded' clause invariably displays the word order of a main clause. Put differently, it exhibits verb-second. This is illustrated by the following alternation:

ModF 1: Hy sei dat hy te let wie.
 he said that he too late was

ModF 2: Hy sei hy wie te let.
 he said he too late was

The absence of the complementiser normally always triggers verb-second. The remarkable observation in the clauses of first person wishes is that the embedded word order is preserved. The

phenomenon is reminiscent of a line of poetry by W.B. Yeats, which features deletion of the main clause subject pronoun, but it is also found as an idiom in ModE:

English¹⁹: *Would that I were a shepherd that I might look daily down upon Urbino.*

ModE: *Wish you were here.*

Returning to Frisian^{17&18}, we also encounter examples involving verbs of judging, as in the following poem:

'k Wed y mey my zisse sille, ...
I bet you with me say shall

Dat dy korte Wrâdsche wille Næt ien ortzen wurdig is.

that that short wordly pleasure not one cent worth is

(1755ri08, *Op dy Forjyer-dey fin myn græte Fryeon Japik Tiboel*, Simon Althuysen)

In the following example, the complementiser is not deleted, but shortened and cliticised onto the matrix clause verb of wishing. The subject pronoun of the embedded clause also appears in its clitic form *er* (full pronoun *hy* 'he'):

Ick woe t ir hier al wier, so mocht ick reys beginne.
I wished that he here already was then could I DcP begin

(1639b, *Ansck in Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

The example comes from Jarich Hoekstra (1993:40), where more information can be found about this fascinating construction.

1.1.2. That clauses with past tense main verb with modal force

Some that clauses just contain a past tense main verb, but they have modal force. The following example involves two past tense verbs, *joegin* 'gave' and *lieten* 'let', which have modal force equivalent to the English auxiliary 'should' or 'must':

My tinckt datt ir jitte het sondarlicx yn e Jonge stijcket/
me thinks that R yet something special in the boy resides
'I think that there is nevertheless something special in the boy'

dat wy him yen hægh en græt namme joegin:
that we him a high and great name gave
'Hence we should give him a high and mighty name'

in lieten him (...) it Docterjen yn e Sted leere.

and let him the doctoring in the town learn

‘and should arrange for him to learn in the city to be a doctor.’

(1701c78, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

The following example is similar, involving the past tense verb *ronste* ‘ran’:

(Waatze) O Mem! 't Bern is soo sieck/ soo sieck it gappit al ney e Zijcke.

(Waatze) o mother! The child is so ill, so ill it yawns already to the breath

‘Waatze: O mother, the child is so ill, so ill, already it almost stops breathing.’

(Sibbel.) Daste tel ney e Sted ronste ney e Doctir

(Sibbel) that.2SG quick to the town ran.2SG to the doctor

‘You should quickly walk to town to the doctor.’

(1701c72, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

Such clauses are not used anymore in ModF. There is a related phenomenon, though. It is possible to use that clauses with the force of main clauses, but they must feature the modal and they tend to express a wish:

ModF: *Dat it jin mar goed bekomme mei!*

that it you.ARB DcP good become may

‘May it agree with you well!’

ModF: *Datst der mar in soad wille fan ha meist!*

that.2SG it.R DcP a lot fun of have may.2SG

‘May it serve you well!’

The presence of the DcP *mar* is almost obligatory in such clauses.

1.1.3. That clauses used as paratactic consecutive clauses

A that clause can be used with a paratactic consecutive meaning, as in the following example:

O Liæve Heere God, het poschin mot my derre

o dear Lord God what pocks must me harm

‘O dear Lord God, what is wrong with me?’

(Dat ick ir æck om flock) Jo boostghe allegerre

that I it.R even about curse they marry all

‘(It even makes me cuss:) they all get married.’

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

There is no syntactic marker in the rhetorical question, to link it up to the consecutive clause expressed as a *that* clause with embedded word order. The linking between the two clauses is therefore paratactic. Normally, consecutive clauses are connected to the preceding clause by the presence of the syntactic marker *sa* ‘so’ in the preceding clause. The presence of DcP *ek* could also indicate that the *that* clause has a concessive interpretation.

1.1.4. Empty *that* clause expressing a high degree

A subtype of consecutive clauses has the marker of high degree *sa* ‘so’ in the preceding clause, and the consecutive clause specifies the high degree evoked by the degree marker. For example: “It was so cold that my hands almost froze.” Frisian features the option of eliding the clause following *that*:

Mijn Aode-boer is za mâôl mei mij dat.

my old farmer is so crazy about me that

‘My old farmer is extremely fond of me.’

(1779m26, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

Hans hie omme holle west za reæd as bloed; en za zwat sjoen dat.

Hans had around.the face been as red as blood and so just.about seen that

‘Hans had been in the face as red as blood and shot a look, so extreme.’

(1779m28, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The latter clause above features a coordination built around two clauses expressing a high degree. The first clause of high degree features a metaphor (‘as red as blood’) as the predicate to the copula, whereas the second clause similarly describes a look charged with a high degree of emotion. This use of the complementiser *that* is also found in ModF, but it is little used in spoken Frisian nowadays, presumably because this use of the complementiser is absent from Dutch.

1.2. The infinitival complementiser *om* ‘for’

1.2.1. Presence or absence of *om* ‘for’

Infinitival clauses in selected contexts are optionally introduced by the complementiser *om* ‘for’ in ModF. The complementiser is less frequently used in F^{17&18} than in ModF. An example is given below:

T is restlyck meij hel fel sliepen to gaen.

it is peaceful with whole skin slept to go

‘It is peaceful to go and sleep with skin unharmed.’

(1614 b1065, *Fryske sprekwurden*, G. van Burmania)

Here the infinitival clause functions as the subject argument of ‘peaceful’. This example would also be grammatical in ModF. In the following example, the infinitival clause is not selected, but the complementiser is nevertheless absent:

Onder uws te peteerien

under us to speak

‘To keep this between us.’

(1614 b803, *Fryske sprekwurden*, G. van Burmania)

The infinitival clause is an idiom, and it is usually followed by an account of what must not be talked about with others. A continuation could be something like “... he is accused of blackmail”, which sounds odd in English but not in Frisian. It is sometimes claimed that the absence of *om* ‘for’ is a ‘germanism’, that is, it is due to 19th century German influence. This cannot be true for F^{17&18}, which is 1-2 centuries earlier. Furthermore, there was no widespread German bilingualism in Frisia, which would be required for such a profound syntactic influence.

1.2.2. Absence of the infinitival marker following the infinitival complementiser

If the complementizer *om* ‘for’ is present, the infinitival marked *te* ‘to’ is occasionally omitted, as in the following examples:

Jæ binne’ op moed, in on-beschromme,

they are on courage and un-abashed

‘They are good-natured and unabashed’

Om wezzen ijn jon huwz wol-komme,

for be in your house welcome

‘to be welcome in your house.’

(1666, *Friessche Tjerne*, Gysbert Japicx)

Want uwz Heer’ Goads sizzen,

for our Lord God’s saying

‘For the sayings of our Lord God’

Iz, naet om weer-lizzen,
 is net for refute
 ‘are not to be refuted’

Inck'le rjuecht-uwte rjuecht:
 just straightforward right
 ‘just straightforward right and justice.’
 (1666, *Friessche Tjerne*, Gysbert Japicx)

These are the only examples in the corpus. Both come from Gysbert Japix; in both cases, the text is poetry, and in both cases, *om* appears next to the infinitival marker. In both cases, omitting the infinitival marker works well metrically. The infinitival verb has the gerundial ending -n, as is required following the infinitival marker.

1.3. The conditional complementiser

1.3.1. Identity of conditional complementiser and resumptive pronoun

The conditional construction is characterised by an embedded condition followed by a main clause result. The conditional clause, introduced by *as* ‘if’, may be resumed in the main clause by the pronoun *dan* ‘then’. However, F^{17&18} also features the word *so* ‘so’, used both as complementiser and as resumptive pronoun:

Jo spriekin jitte wol, dat so ick Vrystir stoor, So kaam ick ijnn e Hel
 you spoke even DcP that if I spinster died then came I in the hell
 ‘You even said, that if I died as a spinster, I would wind up in hell.’
 (1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

This construction comes to the forefront in late Old Frisian.

1.3.2. Conditional clause without complementiser but with embedded word order

A certain type of conditional clause is not introduced by a conditional complementiser:

Ick hab altijden næ mijn Dægin sock in nocht
 I have always never my days such a pleasure
 ‘Never in my days did I experience so much pleasure’

Befeern, als wy dir hien / dy yite so reys mocht
 experienced as we there had that.NNT yet so again might
 ‘as we had over there, if that (pleasure) might happen again’

Ick woe mijn nye Pels wol ijnn e Lommirt sette
 I would my new coat DcP in the pawnshop set
 'I would bring my new coat to the pawnshop (for this).'

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

It is unclear what is going on. It is possible that the complementiser *als* 'as' has been elided by forward gapping, even though the gapped complementiser has a conditional meaning, whereas the overt complementiser is equative.

2. Main clauses, word order, conditional interpretation

2.1. Verb-third

2.1.1. Adverb and subject preceding the verb

A sentential adverb is occasionally allowed to violate the verb-second constraint:

Nimmen woe Borg wudde! Op 't lest, Wipk kriet za fel, en Hans bijloofde
 nobody wanted surety become at last Wipk cried so loud, and Hans promised
 'Nobody wanted to act as a surety. At last, Wipk cried so loud, and Hans promised,'

bij hudde wudden, ijn nije wijke him 't jild ta ien duit ta ijnne hoes ta bringen
 by hard words in new week him the money to a penny to in.the house to bring
 'using strong words, to bring him the money next week at his house to the last penny.'

(1779m28, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

This phenomenon is also found in Flemish dialects.

2.1.2. Conditional clause and subject preceding the verb

In certain sources, the subject almost always separates a conditional subordinate clause at the beginning of the main clause from the finite verb, bringing about a verb-third order:

[az Hepke dat wist], it zoe slim for har stjoere!
 if Hepke that knew it would bad for her steer
 'If Hepke knew that, it would spell trouble for her.'

(1779m20, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

[is 'er ijnne hoes] hij zit folle ta lessen
 is he in.the house he sits much to read
 'If he is in the house, he is reading a lot.'

(1779m21, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

Maer als ick booske hab, y mot in Brulloft jaan
 but if I married have you must a wedding give
 ‘But if I am married, you must throw a wedding reception.’

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

The conditional clause may either be spelled out as an embedded clause following the conditional complementiser or as a verb-initial main clause. This type of verb-third clauses is absent from ModF. The examples above would all be rendered in ModF by means of verb-second clauses, with the finite verb intervening between the conditional clause and the subject.

2.2. Two main clauses in a conditional structure

Two main clauses can function in a conditional structure, in which the condition is resumed by a clause-initial resumptive pronoun *so* ‘then’.

Wotte op 't bed za brui 'er op
 want.2SG on the bed so throw it.R on
 ‘If you want to be on the bed, then throw yourself on it.’

(1779m24, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

astu neat to beste sprecke wotte soo rin du riuw hinne
 if.you nothing to best speak want.2SG then walk you fully away
 ‘If you don’t want to speak good things, then away with you.’

(1701c18, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

It can be appreciated that the verb of the result (consequent) clause is an imperative preceded by the resumptive pronoun. In ModF, the resumptive pronoun would be *dan* ‘then’, and it would be placed in the middle field, not in the front field, as the following contrast illustrates:

Wolst op béd gean der dan op.
 want.2SG on bed go it.R then on
 ‘If you want to be on the bed, (then) go on it.’

* *Wolst op béd dan gean der op.*

The word *so* ‘so’ is not used as a conditional resumptive pronoun in ModF.

3. Adverbs

3.1. The temporal quantifier used as an intensifier

It seems that *altid* ‘always’ could be used in F^{17&18} as an intensifier, as illustrated below:

dit is fen 't boppist boerd! hoe komste 'er bij altijt?
 this is of the highmost shelf how came.2SG it.R by always
 'This is of the highest quality! How on earth did you get it?'

(1779m08, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

Dou biste altijt ien raren snapper
 you are always a weird talker
 'You are always / definitely a weird talker'

(1779m08, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The *Wurdboek fan de Fryske Taal* (WFT) [The dictionary of the Frisian language:

<https://gtb.ivdnt.org/search/?owner=GTB>] gives as a possible meaning for *altyd*: 'that is to say', 'in any case', but this meaning fits the second example above better than the first. In the first example, the quantifier just seems to be used as an intensifier. The fact that the WFT lacks this usage is because the dictionary is confined to Frisian of the 19th and 20th centuries. Nevertheless, I've heard intensifying use of *altyd* in spoken

3.2. Swear words

Surprisingly, swear words or cuss words (abbreviated as CW in the translation) appear in the front field in F^{17&18}, often directly following a question word like *het* 'what'.

het tusin stoeren seyste dir tjinne jonge
 what thousand pennies say.2SG there to.the boy
 'What CW are you telling the boy!'

(1701c76, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

Wa posken soe so faack yne Sted gæn om bootschippen te dwaan/
 who pocks would so often in.the town go for shopping to do
 'Who CW would go so often to the town to do shopping?'

(1701c38, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

In ModF, cuss words tend to appear in the middle field:

Wat hast ferjamme tsjin 'e jonge sein?
 what have.2SG darned to the boy said
 'What CW did you tell the boy?'

? *Wat ferjamme hast tsjin 'e jonge sein?*
 what darned have.2SG to.the boy said

The position of the cuss word might even be lexically determined. The old-fashioned cuss word *blinder* is better in the front field than in the middle field:

Wat blinder sil dit?

what CW shall this

‘What CW are you up to?’

? *Wat hast blinder tsjin 'e jonge sein?*

what have.2SG darned to.the boy said

It would certainly be worthwhile to do some corpus research into the position of cuss words in the clause and into co-occurrence restrictions of cuss word and question word.

3.3. The change from *jit(te)* ‘yet, still’ to *noch*

3.3.1. Word order

In the 17th and 18th centuries, Dutch *noch* ‘yet, still’ began to encroach upon Frisian *jit(te)* ‘yet, still’, ultimately replacing it in the course of the 19th century. The long form *jitte* appears in F^{17&18}, whereas the short form *jit* is the citation form in the 20th century.

Jit was for some time preserved in written language, but it is now obsolete. The word field and position of these two items are highly similar, but there are cases where there is a difference in frequency or markedness. This is explored in more detail below. Consider first the position of *jit*:

schor mij jitte aek en twa trije fen dij blaustreepte doeken oof

tear me yet also a two three of those blue.striped cloths off

‘Cut off some of those blue striped pieces of cloth for me as well.’

(1779m13, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

Zoeste mij jitte eæk ijnne bek hingje? Farken!

would.2SG me yet also in.the beak hang pig

‘Are you contradicting me as well? Pig!’

(1779m26, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

This is the normal order of the two adverbs *jit* and *ek* in F^{17&18}. In ModF, the order of the two adverbs is reversed, with *noch* replacing *jit*:

?* *skuor my noch ek (mar) in twa trije blaustreepte doeken ôf*

tear me yet also (DcP) a two three blue.striped cloths off

<i>skuor my</i>	<i>ek noch (mar)</i>	<i>in twa trije blaustreepte doeken</i>	<i>ôf</i>
tear me	also yet (DcP)	a two three blue.striped cloths	off

Furthermore, ModF usually features the DcP *mar* in such examples, and if *mar* is present, *noch* could be dropped. The meaning of such discourse particles is incredibly complex.

An interesting aspect of this example is that replacing *jit* with *noch* coincides with a change in word order. This example supports the idea that word order is defined in part as a function of the spell-out of individual lexical items. Consequently, the semantic substitution of *jit* with *noch* entails different word orders relative to other discourse particles, because *noch* is subject to different word-order restrictions than *jit*. Thus, borrowing a word can also have consequences for syntax, seeing that *noch* was borrowed from Dutch.

3.3.2. Use in rhetorical questions

There are some clauses in F^{17&18} which cannot be translated into ModF by simply replacing *jit* with *noch*. The first type of cases involves a kind of rhetorical use of *jit*, as illustrated below:

<i>Hoe Jonker wat is dit?</i>	<i>wat/ vrij je</i>	<i>jiet al</i>	<i>meer?</i>
how squire what is this	what woo you	yet DcP.already	more

‘O squire, what is this? How are you wooing even more?’

(P1780w, *Vermakelijke Zamen-Spraak*)

<i>Of Js joon deel</i>	<i>jitte nu</i>	<i>quaetst/</i>
or is your part	yet now	worst

‘Or do you have the worst of it?’

(1701c54, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

The meaning of words like *jit* and *noch* generally involves an extension measured against an expectation. Nevertheless, the examples above cannot be translated into ModF by replacing *jit* with *noch*. It is possible, though, to construct other examples in ModF which are reminiscent of the use of *jit* in F^{17&18}. An example has been given below:

<i>Fine jo</i>	<i>josels</i>	<i>no noch</i>	<i>silich ek?</i>
find you	yourself	now yet	piteous also

‘Do you really think you deserve pity now?’

It can be observed that *jit* comes first in the pair *jit no*, whereas *noch* comes last in the equivalent pair *no noch*. In F^{17&18}, some middle field quantifiers occupy a slightly different position than exhibited by ModF and ModD. In the example above, the quantification does not relate to time, but

rather to the degree of unreasonableness of the person being addressed, in the speaker's judgment. It thus carries a strong rhetorical effect. Consequently, this usage of *jit* frequently appears in rhetorical questions. Attention must also be drawn to the fact that *jit* is paired with other discourse particles, like *noch*. F^{17&18} employs *jit* in the combinations *jit al* and *jit no*, whereas ModF is different in three ways from F^{17&18}:

- *Jit* is the first member of a pair of DcPs, whereas *noch* is the second member:
jitte no is translated as *no noch*.
- ModF adds the DcP *ek* at the end of the clause, whereas this element is absent from the equivalent clauses of F^{17&18}
- *Jit* is replaced with *noch*

There can be little doubt that all three changes are due to the influence of Dutch upon Frisian, seeing that all Frisians are bilinguals, and have been so, even if unbalanced, for a long time. Apparently, then, discourse particles are an element of grammar that is easily borrowed from a second language.

3.3.3. Meaning 'even'

Another rhetorical use of *jit* is illustrated by the clause below:

(Pijttjemoei)	<i>En dat</i>	<i>ijn ien Boerehoes,</i>	<i>Trijn!</i>
	and that	in a farmer's house	
	'Think of it, in a farmer's house, Trijn!'		
(Tryn Bont)	<i>Ja, het mien y?</i>	<i>mar dat wol ik</i>	<i>jitte net næme!</i>
	Yes, what do you think?	Bu that want I	even not name
	'Yest, what do you think? But I don't even want to mention that.'		
	(1779m11, <i>Aagtje IIsbrants</i> , Eelke Meinerts)		

Here the ModF equivalent of *jit* would not be *noch*, but rather *sels* 'even'. The meaning of these adverbs cannot be understood from the clause itself, but the preceding discourse must be taken into account.

3.3.4. Untranslatable use

It doesn't seem possible to translate *jit* in examples like the following:

<i>je ron</i>	<i>za forhæærd</i>	<i>en zei:</i>
she walk	so amazed	and said
'She walked to her in amazement and said:'		

hoe Trijn libje y jitte? hoe giet it jitte al!

how Trijn live you still how goes it yet all

‘What Trijn! Are you still alive? How are you doing?’

ik zei goed! hoe giet it dij, en jimme Folk jitte?

I said good how goes it you and your folks yet

(1779m05, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The occurrences of *jit* which cannot be translated, have been marked in blue. These occurrences would simply be left out in a translation into ModF, or perhaps *jitte al* would be translated as no ‘now’.

3.4. Asking for existential enumeration

ModF asks for an existential enumeration by means of a combination of two DcPs, one homophonous to the affirmative particle, and one homophonous to adverbial negation. Existential enumeration asks for some concrete instances, so it relates to the existential quantifier ‘some’. A discourse example in ModF has been given below:

Ik bestryk no in grutter gebied om myn guod te ferkeapjen.

I cover now a larger area for my goods to sell

‘I now cover a larger area for selling my goods.’

Wêr komsto no dan wol net?

where come.you now then DcP.Aff not

‘So (can you mention some places) where you are now going to?’

F^{17&18} could express this sort of question in a rather different way, as illustrated below:

(Tryn) ... *en ik hab mijn streek eæk hette fierder uitzet ...*

and I have my step also what farther out.set

‘and I am now active (walking to sell my goods) in a larger area

(Aagtje) *Zij za ris! war rinstou dan alleheel wol!*

see so DcP where walk.2SG then al.whole DcP.Aff

‘There! ‘So (can you mention some places) where you are now going to?’

(1779m05, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

It can be observed that the ModF pair *wol net* appears in F^{17&18} as *alleheel wol*. The affirmative DcP *wol* is present in both pairs, but it is followed by negation in ModF, whereas it is preceded by a

universal quantifier in F^{17&18}. This confirms the close relation existing between negation and universal quantification.

4. Adjectives

4.1. Exclusively predicative adjectives with an indirect object

Mâl ‘angry’ could have an indirect object spelled out as a NP:

Ey Mem! wird ws næt maal.

o mother become us not angry

‘O mother, don’t be angry with us!’

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

In this respect, it is similar to *gram* ‘angry’, *sêd* ‘enough’, *kwyt* ‘lost’, which also could be accompanied by an indirect object NP, even until recently, though the presence of such a NP is obsolete by now. These adjectives also have the characteristic that they are exclusively predicative, regardless of whether the indirect object is present. *Mâl* can be used attributively, but then it means ‘crazy’ rather than ‘angry’.

4.2. Indefinite adjective agreement

F^{17&18} had two genders already, just like ModF: non-neuter and neuter. Non-neuter is the conflation of old masculine and feminine gender, which were still present in Old Frisian. Gender is a lexical property of nouns, but it is not visible on the noun itself, but on the definite article. The non-neuter gender is associated in ModF with the definite article *de*, whereas neuter gender is associated with the article *it*. The shortened forms are spelled respectively as: ‘*e*’ and ‘*t*’.

In older Frisian, the adjective often lacks inflection with *de*-words, that is non-neuter words, when the article is indefinite (Bremmer 1992; J. Hoekstra 2000). Bremmer notes that this observation is reported in an old short article on Frisian grammar, written in Latin, dating from somewhere in the middle of the second half of the 16th century (Anonymous ~1575). The following examples are taken from it (Anonymous ~1575: 287):

in moy tzirl ‘a handsome man’

in moy feynt ‘a handsome guy’

in moy faam ‘a beautiful (young) woman’

in moy spicir ‘a nice nail (for hammering)’

Here F^{17&18} is different from ModF. In ModF, the zero-ending only shows up on attributive adjectives if three conditions are met:

1. The preceding article is indefinite
2. The number of the noun (and article) is singular
3. The gender of the noun is neuter

In contrast, F^{17&18} didn't have the third requirement. Hence it displays the zero ending even with non-neuter nouns.

Bremmer (1992) shows that the phenomenon appears in the Burmania proverbs (1614); on this collection of proverbs and expressions, see Van der Kuip (2003). Boersma (1982) had previously demonstrated that this phenomenon also appears in the work of the 19th-century writers, the Halbertsma brothers. Bremmer shows that the phenomenon occurs frequently though not always in the Burmania proverbs, where it is possible for it to occur. The FC ('Frisian Corpora')¹ shows that other texts present a similar picture. Boersma and J. Hoekstra show that at least some 19th-century writers used both the bare form and the inflection found in Modern Frisian, "without any discernible regularity" (J. Hoekstra 2000:115). A frequency analysis could clarify whether certain adjectives favored one form over the other, and whether the nature of the noun is also a significant factor. Bremmer (1992:12,27) points out that a similar phenomenon appeared in the Dutch of the 17th century writer Bredero.

Idiomatic expressions often preserve constructions from earlier stages of the language. Consequently, we still find the phenomenon in question today in idiomatic phrases such as the examples below (J. Hoekstra 2000:118):

<i>in dea baarch</i>	<i>komt it</i>	<i>op in stek</i>	<i>net oan</i>
a dead pig	comes it	on a stab	not to

'Might as well be hanged for a sheep as a lamb.'

<i>in hurd man</i>	<i>op in weak</i>	<i>tsiis</i>
a hard man	on a weak	cheese

'A paper tiger.'

In addition, some indefinite adjectives can be used substantively with zero ending in ModF, as exceptions to the rule that a non-neuter nominalised adjective always ends in schwa. The examples have an idiomatic flavour:

¹ <https://frisian.eu/corpus-frontend/frysk/search>

in frjemd: e.g. *ik wol gjin frjemd oer de flier ha*
 a strange I want no strange on the floor have
 ‘I don’t want strangers in my house.’

in wyld: e.g. *sûpe, flokke as in wyld*
 a wild binge, swear like a wyld
 ‘Binge, swear like a madman.’

Associated with the phenomenon of zero-inflection is the fact that older Frisian featured more compound words consisting of a bare adjective and a noun, such as: *âldman* ‘old man’, *grutjonge* ‘older boy’.

4.3. A strong adjectival ending signalling a high degree interpretation

The adjectival ending *-en*, glossed N, spells out a high degree interpretation in attributive contexts. A characteristic example has been given below:

ja sock in maallin Appe bin y altijden
 yes such a crazy.N monkey are you always
 ‘Yes, you have always been such a crazy monkey.’
 (1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

Sytstra & Hof (1925:96-97) suggest that the *-en* ending was originally the indefinite article *in*. In this construction, the indefinite article could *follow* the adjective, resulting in a phrase like *swiet in dream* ‘sweet a dream’. The construction is comparable to the Big Mess Construction in English, as exemplified by phrases like ‘it is so big a house that ...’. In older Frisian, the indefinite article following the adjective was absorbed by the adjective, yielding forms like *soe swieten dream* ‘so sweet a dream’, which are indeed found in 17th- and 18th-century Frisian.

Van der Meer (1987) wrote an excellent article on this subject. He provides an overview of the syntactic contexts in which the ending is found in older Frisian. The context is identified by specifying the preceding phrase:

- | | | | |
|----|---|--|-------|
| 1. | <i>sa, hoe ...</i>
so, how | <i>soe swietin roock</i>
so sweet.N smell | 1609A |
| 2. | <i>in sa ...</i>
a so | <i>een soo swieten dier</i>
a so sweet.N animal | 1643A |
| 3. | <i>sok in, sa'n ...</i>
such a, such a | <i>sa'n tjoeden dei</i>
such.a bad.N day | 1711B |

4.	<i>in</i> a	<i>in mallin geck</i> a crazy.N fool	1609A
5.	<i>de</i> the	<i>din greatin Loduwyk</i> the.N great.N Louis	1707B
6.	<i>dizze, dy</i> this, that	<i>disse lompen geck</i> this rude.N fool	1711B
7.	poss. pronoun	<i>myn lompen schruft</i> my clumsy.N writing	1755R
8.	genitive noun	<i>Godes gritten tolk</i> God's great.N interpreter	1733A
9.	zero article	<i>lompen praat</i> rude.N talk	1711B
10.	<i>mannich</i> many	<i>mennig eermen buk</i> many.a poor.N belly	1729A
11.	<i>te</i> too	<i>in al ten zwieten laam</i> an all too.N swiet.N lamb	1767D

The set of contexts for the high degree interpretation overlaps a lot with the context in which adjectives exhibit the strong declination, rather than the weak one. The strong declination is characteristically found in all of the contexts above, with the exception of definite contexts such as (6) and (7). See Dyk (2015) for information about how the -n ending is used in literary Frisian of the 20th century for emphasis. It is fair to say that the adjective -n ending is obsolete in the 21st century, bringing ModF more into line with ModD. Finally, Dyk notes that the examples involve subjectively evaluating adjectives, so the speaker assigns the high degree to the adjective based on his subjective evaluation. Dyk notes the following contrast from literary Frisian:

<i>In bloedreaden auto</i>	<i>* In readen auto</i>
a blood.red car	a red car

Red is an objective adjective, so it cannot get the -en ending, whereas bloodred creates a subjective context, in which the adjective may take this suffix. In this connection, the following example from 18th century Frisian is instructive:

soa'n grysen holle

such.a grey head

(1734A, *Heyl- Eer- Yn Zege-Krans*, P. Coupeer)

The adjective grey does not denote an objective colour here but a subjective evaluation of old age. However, what is true for literary Frisian, may be different in F^{17&18}. Thus some of the examples given by Van der Meer in the list cited above would not be found in 20th century literary Frisian. Nevertheless, the notion of a subjectively evaluating context is certainly a good initial characterisation of the set of contexts involved. This is also clear from the adjectives involved.

The phenomenon likely spread from one adjective to another through lexical diffusion. This is suggested by Van der Meer's examples, in which certain adjectives recur repeatedly, such as *swiet* 'sweet', *great* 'great', *moai* 'beautiful, nice', *tsjoed* 'bad', and so on. There also seems a tendency for the *-en* ending to be used with Frisian adjectives which do not phonologically resemble their Dutch semantic counterparts. This is analogous to the finding of Versloot & Hoekstra (2016) that the native *-ens* ending (no Dutch counterpart) attached itself more to adjectival stems lacking a closely resembling Dutch counterpart. To illustrate: *healwiis* 'foolish' (no Dutch counterpart) was found relatively more often with *-ens*, yielding *healwizens* 'foolishness'. In contrast: *wiis* 'wise' (Dutch *wijs*) was found relatively less often with *-ens*, only occasionally yielding *wizens* 'wisdom' instead of the much more common form *wiisheid* (Dutch *wijsheid*).

Tamminga (1963) points out that the intensifying semantic function no longer exists in the Hindeloopen and Schiermonnikoog dialects, because the ending there has evolved into a standard suffix used after *in* 'a', *gjinn* 'no', and *ien* 'one' when followed by a noun. So it seems to have become the normal spell-out for strong adjectival agreement in those dialects. For more information, see the dictionaries of these dialects (Blom & Dyk 2019, Visser & Dyk 2002), both featuring comprehensive grammar, pronunciation keys, and an extensive Dutch/Frisian cross-index.

4.4. The adjective *drok* 'busy' with expletive and verb

The following example involves a fascinating construction which still exists in ModF:

uis Folk hiene 't drok Jouwerrijden

our folks had it busy oat.riding

'Our folks was busy hauling oats.'

(1779m26, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

This fascinating construction is found in ModF as well. It consists of the following elements:

- The auxiliary verb of having

- The expletive object pronoun
- A bare verb spelled out as a gerund

The idiom has been described in J. Hoekstra (1998).² The verb is not accompanied by any objects or modifiers. However, Frisian allows some degree of noun incorporation (Dyk 1997), so the object can be spelled out as the first member of a compound.

4.5. Partitive inflection on adjectives

Adjectives have partitive inflection in ModF:

Ik haw wat nij-s en oar-s kocht.
 I have something new-PI and different.PI bought
 'I bought something new and different.'

There are examples in F^{17&18}, in which only the first adjective of a coordination bears partitive inflection, but not the second one:

za reis hette nijs en mooi ta hebben, der hab ik zin oon
 so DcP something new.PI and beautiful to have it.R have I fancy to
 'To have something new and beautiful, I would like that.'
 (1779m27, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

However, it could also just be a typo.

5. Adpositions

5.1. Body part predication spelled out as PP + AP

Colour predications of a person's head, which stands for the person as a whole, may be spelled out by rendering the body part as a PP in ModF:

Hy wie wyt om 'e holle.
 he was white around the face
 'His face looked pale.'

The colour may also involve a comparison such as 'blood red'. In F^{17&18}, there are examples in which the AP containing the comparison may be extraposed:

Hans hie omme holle west za reæd as bloed
 Hans had around.the face been so red as blood

² See also Language Portal > Frisian: <https://taalportaal.org/taalportaal/topic/pid/topic-13998813336851393>.

‘Hans’ face had been as red as blood.’

(1779m28, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

5.2. Marking person names as places

Person names may be marked as places by adding an -s to them, when they occur following an adposition of place, as in the following examples:

Ik haf ien Dimtre Koeke fin Tryn Annis komje litt’;

I have one Deventer cake of Tryn Anni-s come let

‘I ordered one Deventer cake to be delivered from Tryn Anni’s place’

(1778g, *De prins te Bûtenpost*)

wij wiene korts ta uis Lanhjerre-s

we were short at our land lord-s

‘We recently were at our land lord’s place.’

(1779m09, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The phenomenon is reminiscent of the English genitive found inside PPs of place, as in ‘at the baker’s’. The first example above is remarkable in that it also features the Frisian verb *komme* as a *je*-verb, *komje*. It could just be due to unbalanced bilingualism, but it is certainly worthwhile to study the two classes of verbs in F^{17&18}. Incidentally, the distinction between verbs in -e and verbs in -je cuts across the distinction between regular and irregular verbs, since some irregular verbs have infinitives in -je (see Merkuur 2021).

5.3. Noun predicated of a Prepositional Complement

The Evaluative Binominal Construction involves an NP-internal predication in which a prepositional complement is predicated of the noun, as in: ‘a giant of a man’. An example from ModF has been given below:

in skat fan in bern

a treasure of a child

‘a darling of a child’

The ModF construction is comparable to its Dutch equivalent. The subject is expressed as an indefinite NP functioning as prepositional complement. The construction was expressed somewhat different in F^{17&18}, as illustrated by the following examples:

Doe forfijske dat porkes ta Famke, dat Trijn 'er west hie.

then snitched that pig to girl that Trijn there been had

‘Then that pig of a girl snitched that Tryn had been there.’

(1779m26, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

Dij dogenieten ta Manljuw dy zoene jin gek meitze.

those villains to men those would you.ARB crazy make

‘Those villains of men are enough to drive a person crazy.’

(1779m26, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The construction of F^{17&18} differs from ModF, ModD and ModE in two respects:

- The preposition is directional *ta* ‘to’ rather than the possessive preposition.
- The semantic subject noun inside the PP is not marked with an indefinite article.

It would be interesting to investigate the history of this construction in Dutch and English. Lexically, note the use of the word *porkes*, which is only found once in the Frisian Corpus, at least in this spelling. It probably derives from Latin *porcus* ‘pig’.

6. Pronouns

6.1. Relative pronoun

ModF exhibits homophony of the relative pronoun with the demonstrative pronoun, which is also used as topic pronoun. This pronoun is declined for number and gender. In contrast, OF and early ModF used indeclinable *der* as the relative pronoun. It was used for persons, places and things. Some examples have been given below:

Lit him oos mar oonkomme / of de Feint der 't by him leerd het

let him else DcP come or the student REL it at him learned has

‘Just let him visit me, or the student who learned it from him.’

(1779a, *Mayke Jakkelis*, Feike van der Ploeg)

... mej verbljje opp e groun der uws God oon har het ijoun

... may rejoice on the ground REL ouer God to them has given

‘... may rejoice on the land which our God gave them.’

(1649, *En friesch brillofts freughde to loff/ fenden ... Jr. Frans fen/ eijsinga*, Pieter Freercks)

The indeclinable relative pronoun could also be used as a free relative:

Der it âdde Gryecks wol lærre, Moat him oer Homerus hærre:

REL the old Greek wants learn must REF on Homer hear

‘Whoever wants to learn Greek, must hear about Homer.’

(1745a, *Oon dy Hæggeleerde Man Harmen Venema*, Jan Althuysen)

Ja hattje, az y wisten der ik wit, y zoene wol oors tinze
yes heart of you knew REL I knew you would DcP else think

‘Yes darling, if you knew what I know, you would think differently.’

(1779m06, *Aagtje IIsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The indeclinable relative pronoun could be used to bind an overt possessive pronoun:

Dit rint lyæfferts wer toa heeg, Der fin nyed har heelle holle Is opswolle,
this walks cowards DcP to high REL of jealousy their whole head is up.swollen

‘This is too much for cowards, whose heads are swollen up out of jealousy.’

(1746e, *Oon dy brauwe, in schrandre Jongfeynt Pytter Bondam*, Jan Althuysen)

The following example is remarkable, since it features the relative pronoun where ModF would use the complementiser *oft* ‘if (=whether)’:

en ek net sisse zil / op het Plæets der de Boeren wenje.
and also not say shall on what farm REL the farmers live

‘and also wouldn’t say on what farm the farmers live’

(1778g, *De prins kaam te Bûtenpost*)

Frisian may exhibit a complementiser following a wh-phrase opening an embedded clause. Modern Frisian may use *oft* or *‘t* or *dat* or ZERO, depending also on the wh-phrase involved and its interpretation.

Indirectly related is the fact that the locative resumptive pronoun may be dropped in ModF in examples like the following:

Ljouwert (dêr) wol ik net wenje.
Leeuwarden (there) want I not live

‘Leeuwarden, I don’t want to live (there).’

Occasionally, the ModF type of relative is found in older Frisian, that is, the type of relative that is homophonous to the distal demonstrative pronoun, like in ModD:

Datt ir in Vryer comt die dy dir fen forlost.
that there a lover comes REL.NTR.SG you it.R of free

‘That there a boyfriend comes who delivers you from it.’

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

Originally, this must have been an interference, but it may quickly have become part of the Frisian language as an alternative to indeclinable *der*.

6.2. A difficult relative clause

The following example is rather difficult to evaluate:

It is in wonder wirck, ick ken it næt uyt-sprecke
it is a wonder work I can it not out-speak
'It is a strange case, I can't put into words'

Ho droevich dat ick bin: Dy ijn e Hijmmel wier.
how sad that I am who in the heaven was
'How sad I am. Wish I was in heaven.'

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

The weird clause superficially has the appearance of a relative clause, but this doesn't fit the context. So the clause cannot mean "I who was in heaven", because the previous context is just that the woman Houck is suffering because she gets older without being married. Brouwer & Hellinga (1935:28) noted this problem. They refer to this clause as a 'anacolouth', a construction which is not integrated in the syntactic context, but they don't explain how the clause should be interpreted. I took the clause to express a death wish, since that fits the preceding and following context: Houck is in despair, before she gets new courage from the conversation with her mother.

6.3. An embedded question with verb-second

The following example involves an embedded question featuring verb-second:

Ick boosk ir din op oon / al soe t ir al om gæn /
I married it.R then on to though would it R.it DcP about go
'Then I would certainly marry, though it would indeed matter,'

Het Pockin leyt ir fen
what pocks suffers he from
'From what pocks does he suffer?'

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

The example could perhaps be heard in spoken ModF as well, though not in written Frisian. The connection between the embedded verb-second clause and the previous clause must be paratactic, not syntactic, though this amounts to just putting a name on an observation.

6.4. Positioning of the R-pronoun as a clitic

As is well-known, the R-pronoun is used in ModF and ModD for pronouns functioning as prepositional complements. The pronoun is not differentiated for number or gender. The unmarked R-pronoun *der* is homophonous to the relative pronoun. In F^{17&18}, the clitic form of the R-pronoun could be placed before object pronouns, following the subject pronoun:

<i>Dan zet</i>	<i>ze</i>	<i>'er</i>	<i>har</i>	<i>nou</i>	<i>jīn op!</i>
then puts	she	R.it	REF	no	against up

‘Then she now puts up resistance against it.’

(1779m20, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

<i>doe ze</i>	<i>'er hem</i>	<i>oer bestraften,</i>	<i>dat it</i>	<i>Boere-einen wiene</i>
when they	R.it him	about rebuked	that it	farmer’s-ducks were

‘When they rebuked him for the fact that they were farmer’s ducks’

(1779m10, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The R-pronoun, in clitic form, is construed with the preposition, which has been shaded in yellow. In ModF, the R-pronoun would normally be placed following the object pronoun, as in the following example:

<i>Dan ferset se</i>	<i>har der</i>	<i>no</i>	<i>tsjin.</i>
then resists she	REF R.it	now	against

<i>?* Dan ferset se</i>	<i>der har</i>	<i>no</i>	<i>tsjin</i>
then resists she	R.it REF	now	against

So the positioning of the R-pronoun as a clitic changed from F^{17&18} to ModF, most likely under the influence of Dutch.

6.5. Resumptive adverbial pronoun *sa* ‘so’

6.5.1. For preposed constituents

The adverbial pronoun *sa* ‘so’ could be used to resume preposed constituents which it cannot resume anymore in ModF. To illustrate, consider the following example from F^{17&18}:

Js 't om mij te dwaan / of is 't om mijn eer/
is it for me to do or is it for my honour
‘Is this about me, or is it about taking my honour,’

Want oars sa ha ik net / ik bin ien eerre boode.

for other.PI so have I not I am a poor servant

‘for anything else, I haven’t got, I am a poor servant.’

(1750?, *Vermakelijke Zamen-Spraak*)

In ModF, the resumptive pronoun *dat* ‘that’ would be preferred. Furthermore, ModF would express ‘something else’ not just by the adverb *oars* but by adding the indefinite quantifier *wat*, homophonous to the question word:

Want wat oars, dat haw ik net.

for something else that have I not

Older ModF also featured the reverse word order:

Want oars wat ha ik net.

for else something have I not

‘For something else, I haven’t got.’

In ModF, *sa* ‘so’ can be used to resume PPs of manner. Throughout the centuries, the use of the functional item *sa* ‘so’ has become more and more restricted, both in Dutch and in Frisian. See also J. Hoekstra (2000), who maintains that in Modern Frisian *oars* functions as the negation of *sa*; for older Frisian, however, that cannot be the whole story, given the sentences above.

6.5.2. For conditional clauses

So / *sa* ‘so’ is used to resume conditional clauses, whereas ModF uses *dan* ‘then’. An example has been given below:

Tjalle wotte bortje / so schu de porte to

Tjalle want.2SG play then shove.IMP the door to

‘Tjalle, do you want to play, then close the door shut.’

(1602, *Tjalle wotte bortie*, Vredeman)

The first clause has the force of a conditional clause, and it is resumed in the following clause by *sa* / *so*. In ModF, it could be phrased as follows:

Tjalle, ast boartsje wolst, sko dan de doar ticht.

Tjalle, if.2SG play want.2SG close.IMP the door to

‘Tjalle, if you want to play, then close the door shut.’

It can be appreciated that the order of imperative verb and resumptive pronoun is reversed in ModF as compared against the example from 1602. Over time, *sa* / *so* has been replaced by *dan*. A

characteristic of *sa* / *so* was that it could precede the imperative, whereas *dan* lacked this property. The replacement of one lexical item by another thus had consequences for the ordering of the resumptive pronoun with respect to the imperative form of the verb.

The phonological change from *so* to *sa* took place in the 17th century, even though *so* was supported by Dutch *zo*. Thus there were also changes in Frisian which moved away from Dutch.

6.6. Question word for exclamations

The question word *hoe* 'how' is used for exclamations in F^{17&18}, where ModF would use *wat* 'what':

doe togt ik, heden! hoe is dat preekjen!
then thought I present! How is that preaching
'Then I thought, O my, now that is preaching.'
(1779m18, *Aagtje IIsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The decline or specialization of *hoe* 'how' might well run parallel to the specialization of *sa* 'so', given that these two words, as interrogative and answer, belong together.

7. Quantifiers

7.1. The universal temporal quantifier as an intensifier of negation

The universal temporal quantifier is used to intensify negative clauses, as in the following example:

Ick hab altijden næ mijn Dægin sock in nocht Befeern, als wy dir hien
I have always never my days such a pleasure experienced as we there had
'In my days, I have never ever experienced such pleasure as we had there.'
(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

Consider the sequence *altyd næ myn dagen*. The first element is the universal temporal quantifier *altyd* 'always'. Here, it does not carry its literal meaning but functions as an intensifier for the negation. This is no longer possible in Modern Frisian. An intensifying use of this quantifier is possible in Modern Frisian within an affirmative sentence, such as: *dat moat altyd wêze* 'that should happen, we should do that', where its meaning can be described as 'definitely' or 'certainly'. The second element in the sentence above is the negative temporal adverb *nea* 'never'. The third element is the negative polarity phrase *myn dagen* 'in my days', which frequently appears alongside negation, but it also occurs in rhetorical questions.

A difficult example is the following, which is not negative, but which does seem to feature the quantifier as an intensifier:

Het soe ick mey socke Follin?

what would I with such foals

‘What should I do with such foolish men?’

*Ick binn er **altijd** ien allinne wol fen dwaan*

I am R.them always one alone DcP of do

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

Its meaning is not quite clear. Brouwer gives as meaning for the quantifier ‘at least’, but that doesn’t quite fit the context. Perhaps it means: ‘I could indeed concern myself with only one of them.’

7.2. The neuter existential quantifier & question word

The existential quantifier *wat* ‘something’ is homophonous to the question word *wat* ‘what’ in ModF and ModD. This also applies to F^{17&18}, except that its lexical form was: *het*. *Het* was pushed out by *wat* around 1800, it seems from inspection of the *Frisian Corpora* (<https://frisian.eu/corpus-frontend/frysk/search>).

7.3. The quantifier *witte* ‘know’

The adverbial quantifier *witte* is a weakened form of *wit hoe* ‘know how’, and this is a reduction of *wa wit hoe* ‘who knows how’ (Dyk 1988). The oldest occurrence of *wit hoe* is from 1783:

Hy sprick fin de Keizer, hoe er oon 't reizen wier,

hy spoke of the emperor how he to the travelling was

‘He spoke of the emperor, how he was travelling’

*en dat uis Oorlog mey de Engelsen him **wit hoe folle** fordiel oonbrenge soe.*

and that our war with the English him know how much profit bring would

‘and that our war with the English would bring him an incredible amount of profit.’

(1783I, *Het Sneeker Jaagschuitje*)

Wit hoe folle ‘so much, nobody knows’ thus is a marker of a very high degree, sometimes referred to as an elative. A sentence containing *wa wit hoe* is found as early as 1743, but here the connection with the rest of the clause is paratactic:

Dij hie opp e schouders lissen len wijtte proek, wa wit hoe lang!

that had on the shoulders lie.GI one white wig who knows how long

‘He had a white wig lying on his shoulders, who knows how long.’

(1741, *Op 't trouwen fan Japik Renalda mei Maike Midwerda*)

The sentence bears out Dyk’s analysis that *witte hoe* derives from the rhetorical question *wa wit hoe*.

7.4. Negative polarity of the temporal quantifier

Ea is a word that does not appear in affirmative sentences in F^{17&18}, though it can be found as such in ModF, as shown below:

Ik ha ea yn Rome west op fakânsje.

I have ever in Rome been on vacation

‘I once spent my holidays in Rome.’

This is due to influence from Dutch. Hoeksema (1998) has shown that such sentences have only appeared in Dutch in recent years. They illustrate an extension of functions, from negative polarity item to existential quantifier.

In F^{17&18}, the word *ea* ‘ever’ has the distribution of a weak negative polarity item. It occurs in the following syntactic contexts:

- Rhetorical question:

Dear duvvckt ijnn’ djiept’, dear djoeyt lânz’ strânne’ in ree,

there dives in the deep there plays along beach and anchorage

‘Into the deep are diving, along beach and anchorage are playing’

So folle’er hanne Fisk, wa schoe se’ ea sommje?

so many hand fish who would them ever sum

‘so many kinds of fish, who could ever sum them up?’

(~1640, *Friessche Tjerne*, Gysbert Japicx) (Psalm 104:25)

- With a negative phrase:

Dat nin forby geand’ minsche’, ijnn’ Heer’ Goads Namm’, Ea wolfearte uwtteje:

that no away passing human in.the Lord God’s name ever blessing express

‘let no mere mortal ever express blessing in the name of the Lord’

(~1640, *Friessche Tjerne*, Gysbert Japicx) (Psalm 129:8)

- With a clause introduced by a negative or privative word:

buwtte hoop fen him æ weer to siean

outside hope of him ever again to see

‘without hope of ever seeing him again’

(~1666, *Historje Fen Dorilis in Cleonice*, Gysbert Japicx)

- Within a free relative clause

Lofsjong God, dy æ tjienners Goads rjuecht hiett'ne,
 praise God REL ever servants Gods rightly were.called
 'Praise God, (you) whoever were rightly called Gods servants.'
 (~1640, *Friessche Tjerne*, Gysbert Japicx) (Psalm 103:21)

- Within a relative clause with an antecedent

Dy steez-oon, oon sijn ker tjiens-firdig jeften,
 who continually to his will serviceable gifts(?)
 'who continually were ready to serve his will'

Om [so] to rjuechtjen 't wird dat hy æ joe.
 for so to fulfill the word which he ever gave
 'and so to fulfill whichever word he gave'
 (~1640, *Friessche Tjerne*, Gysbert Japicx) (Psalm 103:18)

In an ordinary negative sentence, so with plain clause negation, *ea* doesn't appear, which makes it a weak NPI. The use of *ea* in relative clauses with an antecedent is striking. Our modern linguistic intuition no longer accepts such examples—at least not when the noun phrase does not contain a superlative adjective. Such 'counter-intuitive' examples all originate with Gysbert Japicx.

Ea was replaced by *oait* after 1700 (see next chapter). *Ea* is used to this day in written Frisian, but it is just a hypercorrect translation equivalent of Dutch *ooit*, spelled in ModF as *oait*. Interestingly, the form *ea* does not appear at all between roughly 1700 and 1830. It was revived in the language by Frisian activists in the 19th century, aiming to establish a standard Frisian language. Standardization often goes hand in hand with distancing, in this case, distancing from Dutch, and *ea* and *nea* are more suitable for distancing than *oait* and *noait*.

Furthermore, *ea* does eventually appear once in an affirmative sentence in F^{17&18}, but in that instance, it carries the meaning 'always'. This was very common in Old Frisian (Hoekstra, Slofstra & Versloot 2009). We return to the subject of *ea* in section 8.2, comparing its distribution to that of its competitors *oait* and *syn leven*.

7.5. Sequence of numerals with a disjunctive interpretation

A noun could be preceded and followed by a numerals, and the numerals would receive a disjunctive interpretation, as in the following example:

Ik naam ien tjoek stik Bræe / mey Tjies / En der ien Bak twa by
 I took one thick slice bread with cheese and R.it one rusk two with

‘I took one thick slice of bread with cheese, and one two rusks with it.’

(1778g, *De prins kaam te Bûtenpost*)

jæ ... zil op it minst ien wijke zegs zân ôon fest wesse;

she will at the least one week six seven to stuck be

‘She will at least be stuck with it six or seven weeks.’

(1779m28, *Aagtje IIsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The first numeral is *ien* ‘one’, either interpreted as a real numeral, as in the first example, or as an indefinite pronoun, as in the second example. Note that two numerals follow the noun in the second example. On this phenomenon in ModF, see J. Hoekstra (1992). The ModF expression *in dei of trije* ‘a day or three’ features the disjunct *of* ‘or’.

8. Negation and negative polarity

8.1. The distribution of the NPI: *syn leven* ‘his life > ever’

F^{17&18} features the NPI *syn leven* ‘his life’. The vocalism of the noun *leven* ‘life’ makes it clear that it was a borrowing from Dutch. The Frisian form is *libben* ‘life’. The Dutch noun *leven* was borrowed as part of the expression as a whole *syn leven* ‘his life’, for it hardly occurs outside this NPI. Outside this NPI, we systematically find the Frisian form *libben* ‘life’. Inside the NPI, both the Dutch form *leven* and occasionally the Frisian form *libben* may be found.

All occurrences of this construction occur in the following syntactic environments:

- clauses with sentence negation
- rhetorical questions
- comparative relatives
- exclamatives

Two examples of each of these construction types will be given below, where the NPI and its trigger have been shaded in blue.

8.1.1. Clauses with negation

Goe nacht mijn lieve Hoonne, mijn leven sioegh ick dy neat weer.

good night my dear rooster my life see I you not again

‘Good night, my sweet dog, never in my life will I see you again.’

(1701c32, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

Dat giet *zijn leven* *net goed!*

that goes his life not good

‘That will never end well!’

(1779m54, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

8.1.2. Rhetorical questions

Wa het *sijn libben* *herd fen* *socke botte dingen?*

who has his life heard of such terrible things

‘Who has ever heard of such terrible things?’

(1711b, *Klugtige t'Saamenspraak Tusschen een Edelman en een Boer*, D. Simonides)

Heste *dijn libben* *zok foelbekjen* *wol heard?*

have.2sg your life such foul.speak.GI DcP heard

‘Did you ever hear such foul speech?’

(1779m38, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

8.1.3. Equative clauses

It is *zok maol praat* *az ik* *mijn leven* *heard hab!*

it is such crazy talk as I my life heard have

‘It is such crazy talk as I have never heard before.’

(1779m42, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

Hij joeg mij *zokke eermhartige en leæve wudden,* *az ik mijn leven fen him hân hab.*

he gave me such tender and sweet words as I my life from him had have

‘He gave me such tender and sweet words as I had never received from him before.’

(1779m27, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

Note that the Frisian clause lacks a negation, whereas the translation requires the insertion of a negation. So the NPI itself behaved as a kind of negation in equative clauses in F^{17&18}.

8.1.4. Exclamatives

Nou hab ik *mijn leven! ...* *hoe bijtinke* *dij Minschen ‘t!*

now have I my life how think those people it

‘Well upon my soul! ... How do those people come up with it!’

(1779m10, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

Wa het *sijn libben,* *sjugh uws Rinse* *begint om boostgjen* *nu to tinsen.*

who has his life see our Rinse begins of marrying now to think

‘Upon my soul! Look here! Our Rinse is thinking of marrying.’

(1671a, *Ackrumer Friesche-Boere Almanach*, Jan Sickes)

8.1.5. As complement to the universal quantifier

The phrase can also show up as the complement to the universal quantifier *al* ‘all, whole’. The NP complement of the universal quantifier is monotone decreasing, so it is weakly negative. Thus the universal quantifier must be considered the trigger for the NPI:

Wa iensen stelt *Is* *all zijn leuen* *ien tieeff.*

who once steals is all his life a thief

‘Once a thief, always a thief.’

(1614 b1125, *Fryske sprekwurden*, G. van Burmania)

Ven sokke lieuwe *sil ik* *al mijn libben* *spijë.*

of such people shall I all my life vomit

‘Such people always make me sick.’

(1764a, *Den Heere D.I. Slotsboo*, E. Wassenbergh)

8.1.6. Agreement of the NPI with the subject

It can also be observed that the possessive pronoun inside the NPI agrees in person and number with its antecedent (the subject of the sentence) in the majority of occurrences of this NPI. Some examples are given below:

Ick hie t oors *mijn* *leven* *neat ljæuwd.*

I had it else my life not believed

‘Otherwise, I would never have believed it.’

(1701c48, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

Du hefste my *dijn* *leven* *soo folle wille* *neat joon.*

you have me your life so much fun net given

‘You never gave me so much pleasure.’

(1701c6, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

Hij zoe ‘t *zijn* *libben* *net dwaan!*

he would it his life not do

‘He would never do it!’

(1779m34, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

But it is not the case that there is always agreement with the subject. Of the sixty-four examples found in the corpus, five unambiguously exhibit lack of agreement. In those cases, the possessive pronoun is either 1sg or 3sg, while the subject has different person and number features. Two examples are given below:

Hab jimme zijn leven zok Folk meer heard?
have you.PL his life such folk more heard
‘Have you ever heard of such people (in your life)?’
(1779m34, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

Za hab ik Jjerren lang æak ney de vammen Rjon
so have I years long also to the girls walked
‘I for one went after girls for years.’

der hat mijn Boese noyt myn leeven net van wjon.
there has my pocket never my life not of gain
My wallet never in my life profited from it.’
(1762a, *By Geleegentheid dat ik met wopke Poppes schip lag bevrooren op Nyezyl*, B. Fabrycius)

The last example is especially interesting. The subject is 3rd person, strictly speaking, but the possessor of the subject is 1st person, like the possessor inside the NPI. Furthermore, this example features two negations, *noyt* ‘never’ and *net* ‘not’, which do not cancel each other, but they reinforce each other.

The remaining 59 examples (of 64) show agreement of the possessive pronoun with the subject. For more information, see Hoekstra & Slofstra (2013). This NPI is the only way in which the concepts of *ever* and *never* are expressed in the vulgar comedy *Waatze Gribberts’ Brulloft*. This comedy provides an extremely accurate sample of spoken Frisian. This NPI apparently pushed out the native pair *ea* /*nea*, before it was itself marginalised by another loan from Dutch, *oait* / *noait*.

8.2. The distribution of the NPI *ea* ‘ever’

8.2.1. As a universal quantifier in Old Frisian

F^{17&18} features the NPI *ea* ‘ever’, which is the reflex of Old Frisian *a* ‘ever’. Old Frisian *a* could occur in affirmative main clauses with the meaning ‘always’. This may be related to the fact that OF lacked a lexical temporal quantifier such as ModE *always*, ModF *altyd*. The earliest attestations of Frisian *altyd* date from around 1500. After 1500, there is only 1 occurrence of *a* / *ea* meaning ‘always’. It makes sense to suppose that the rise of *altyd* implied that the distribution of *a* / *ea* was curtailed so that *a* / *ea* couldn’t occur anymore in plain main clauses with the meaning ‘always’.

8.2.2. The competitors of *ea* ‘ever’

The distribution of *ea* was further curtailed by two competitors, borrowed from Dutch, able to express the meaning ‘ever’:

- The NPI *syn leven* ‘his life’ discussed in the preceding section.
- The Dutch equivalent of *ea*, that is: *oait*, to be discussed in the following section.

This section focuses on the native form *ea* ‘ever’. All occurrences of *ea* occur in the following syntactic environments:

- clauses containing a negative DP
- clauses introduced by an excluding head such as comparatives, superlatives, lexemes like *outside of*, etc.
- (free) relative clauses
- rhetorical clauses

Two examples of each of these construction types are given below, where *ea* and its trigger have been shaded in blue.

8.2.3. Clauses containing a negative DP

me hie t' oore tyden befuwnne

ARB had in other times observed

‘It was observed in earlier times’

dat nin Maeghden fen dit Ater-fioer æ beschædge wierne

that no virgins of this altar-fire ever harmed were

‘that no virgins were ever harmed by this altar fire.’

(~1666, *Dorilis in Cleonice*, Gysbert Japicx)

in beleauwe dat nimmen az hy æ her ynborst besitte schoe

and promised that nobody but he ever her inside possess would

‘and promised that nobody but he would ever have her heart’

(~1666, *Dorilis in Cleonice*, Gysbert Japicx)

8.2.4. Clauses introduced by an excluding head

O ljeacht, uwt ljeacht bern', buwtte' æ tijdz beginne!

O light out.of light born outside ever time’s beginning

‘O light born of light, outside of time beginning’

(~1666, *Moarn-Liet*, Gysbert Japicx)

mar nu hy se fuwn het, ænget hy for dy struwck-roavers **meer** az **ea**
 but now he them found has fears he for the highwaymen more than ever
 ‘But now that he found them, he fears the highwaymen more than ever.’

(~1666, *Yen suwnerlinge forhânlinge*, Gysbert Japicx)

8.2.5. (Free) relative clauses

Mar, ô, d' rie uwz Heer'ne, **Dy** Hy **æ** uwt-eerne, Stiet ijnn e' yvigheyt
 but o the plan our Lord which He ever out-thought stands in the eternity
 ‘But O the plan of our Lord which he ever conceived, stands in eternity.’

(~1666, *Psalm 33*, Gysbert Japicx)

for de leste wirdden **dyste** **æ** sprecke schitte
 for the last words which.2SG ever speak shall.2SG
 ‘for the last words which you will ever speak’

(~1666, *Paris verlittende Enone*, Gysbert Japicx)

8.2.6. Rhetorical clauses

Lyckje wy **ea** better ien dea minsche den as wy sliieppje
 resemble we ever better a dead person than when we sleep
 ‘Do we ever resemble a dead person more than when we sleep?’

(~1666, *Yen suwnerlinge forhânlinge*, Gysbert Japicx)

Waa seeag **eea** sokk in Faam / As strax mej Ulbe kaam
 who saw ever such a girl as just with Ulbe came
 ‘Whoever saw such a girl, as just came with Ulbe?’

(1702 *Jen aad Friesk/ Deuntje/ azme to Keeamer/ giet*)

A category of clauses in which *ea* has not been found is clauses with plain clause negation. It may be noted that all examples of *ea* are found before 1720. After 1720, the Language Corpus doesn’t return any hits for the lemma *ea*. Note that *ea* ‘ever’ forms a pair with *nea* ‘never’. One would expect that the pair as a whole goes out of use. This is indeed the case. After 1720, the Language Corpus doesn’t return any hits for the lemma *nea* either! The native pair *ea* / *nea* has been ousted by the borrowing from Dutch *oait* / *noait*. However, the native pair is resurrected by the Frisian language revival of the 19th century. Thus we find numerous attestations of *ea* / *nea* after 1824 (see the *Wurdboek fan de Fryske Taal* [Dictionary of the Frisian Language] at: <https://gtb.ivdnt.org/search/?owner=GTB>). It is mainly found in written language, and it is spoken by language enthusiasts who incorporated it in their speech or when quoting written language. Nevertheless, it is disappearing out of the written

language, owing to the weak position of Frisian in the present-day educational system, in the political system of The Netherlands and in the Frisian society at large.

8.3. The distribution of the NPI *oait* ‘ever’

8.3.1. Overview

F^{17&18} features the NPI *oait* ‘ever’, which is a borrowing from Dutch. This section focuses on the borrowed form *oait* ‘ever’. All occurrences of *oait* occur in the following syntactic environments:

- clauses with clause negation
- clauses containing a negative DP or another constituent negation
- clauses introduced by an excluding head such as comparatives, superlatives, lexemes like *outside of*, etc.
- (free) relative clauses
- rhetorical clauses

Two examples of each of these construction types are given below, where *oait* and its trigger have been shaded in blue.

8.3.2. Clauses with clause negation

Der smakkit Hy ien freugd, dy oyt næt eynje sil.
 there tastes he a joy which ever not end shall
 ‘There he tastes a joy, which will never end.’

(1747B, *Op it Zelle*, Jan Althuysen)

Joa sil oyt næt krimmenærje, Noyt ien suwr gesigt him jaan
 she will ever not complain never a sour face him give
 ‘She won’t ever complain, never give him a sour look.’

(1755, *Ien Fryesk Rymke op dy Forjyerdey fin Gærtje Pôthôf*, Jan Althuysen)

This clause type is peculiar, because the trigger, clause negation, normally follows the NPI. Furthermore, this clause type is never attested with the native NPI *ea*. Thus we never find the sequence: *ea net*, equivalent to *oait net*. The question arises whether this clause type was borrowed from spoken Dutch, when *oait* was borrowed. A more probable explanation is that *oait net* replaced *syn leven net*, when the latter was felt to be vulgar. In any case, the lack of *ea* with clause negation handicapped *ea* in its competition with the two rival NPI’s borrowed from Dutch.

A possible beginning of an analysis of the order *oait net* could be that *oait* is both a Negative Polarity Item and a Positive Polarity Item, and that a distinction is made between c-command requirements

which must reconstruct and those which may not or need not. Thus the anti c-command requirement for the PPI would not reconstruct whereas the c-command requirement for the NPI would reconstruct, so that *oait net* would neatly be grammatical. A remarkable example of this NPI licensed by clause negation is the following:

Om dat joa oyt of oyt næt lette Op Goads wurk
 for that they ever or ever not heed on God's work
 'because they never ever heed God's work'

(1755, *Friesche/ Rymlery/ Yn Twaa Dielen bystænde: Psalm 28*, Jan Althuysen)

Here we have a disjunction which is just a repetition of the NPI, and apparently, it has the force of emphasis or reinforcement.

8.3.3. Clauses containing a negative DP or another constituent negation

Remarkably, the order of *oait* and its licenser is reversed if the negation is not adjacent to the NPI, or if the negation functions as constituent negation, in this case, as a negation of the NP 'hour' in the first example, and the negation of the AP 'godless' in the second example:

Nin bleyer ouyr ouis oyt de Britse Krytstrân joeg (dan asse ...)
 no happier hour us ever the British chalk.beach gave than when
 'No happier hour did the British chalk beach us ever gave (than when ...)'

Om dat ik trouw hab yn zyn paadden wânle,
 for that I faithful have in his paths walked
 'because I have faithfully walked in His ways'
 (1734, *Heyl- Eer- yn Zege-Krans*, P. Coupeer)

In tyen myn Goad næt goadlæz oyt hab hânle
 and against my God net godless ever have acted
 'and never acted godlessly against my God'
 (1755, *Friesche/ Rymlery/ Yn Twaa Dielen bystænde: Psalm 18*, Jan Althuysen)

Jigt / nog kramp / nog ore seeren, Komme Oijt bij jou verkeeren
 gout nor cramps nor other pains come ever at you be.around
 'May neither gout nor cramps nor other pains ever be with you.'
 (1769D, *Samenspraak*, J. Sjoerds)

The third example involves a negative NP in the form of a negative coordination. Such embedded negations make the constituent in which they occur a negative constituent, but these constituents

have different negative properties from raw clause negation itself, as is clear from the patterns of inference uncovered by work within the theory of generalized quantifiers (Zwarts 1981 and others).

However, even if negation is embedded in a constituent, there are examples of the opposite order, in which the NPI precedes the negative constituent, such as the following:

Dat joa mogge 't libben slytte. Buwtten kibjen, in eltzoor Oyt nin liltzigheyt forwytte
 that they may the life live without discord and each other ever no evil blame
 ‘that they may live together without quarrelling and accuse each other of no evil deeds ever’
 (1749, *Brullofts-Kranse op 't Friesk Gær Frussele for Ernst Willem Higt*, Jan Althuysen)

8.3.4. Clauses introduced by an excluding head

In the following example, the comparative adjective licenses the NPI inside the comparative clause:

Hij litte lærre schæ, As dat hy oyt ien minsch soe ongelyk bylizze
 hy suffered rather damage as that he ever a person would unfairly treat
 ‘He would prefer to suffer rather than treating anyone else unfairly.’
 (1747c, *Op it Zelle*, Jan Althuysen)

In the following examples, the excluding heads ‘before’ and ‘without’ license the NPI:

Dat mij ien koegel reitse, eiar ik ien slaaf ooit hiet
 that me a bullet hit before I a slave ever was.called
 ‘May a bullet hit me, before I am ever called a slave.’
 (1784, *Oon mijne Lansgenieaten it Nederdwietsche vin J.A. Backer*, Durk Lenige)

zoender ooit, as dol neij wreck te hekjen
 without ever as crazy for revenge to desire
 ‘without ever, as in a frenzy, to lust for revenge’
 (1784, *Oon mijne Lansgenieaten it Nederdwietsche vin J.A. Backer*, Durk Lenige)

The following example displays a combination of two NPI’s:

Do .. waard ick sa kel / as ick oyt mijn libbin west hie
 then became I so afraid as I ever my life been had
 ‘Then I got so afraid as I have never been in my life.’
 (1778, *Ney-Redin op it Frieske Boere Almanack*)

Here it seems that the NPI *oait* is licensed in an equative clause, but it actually just functions as a reinforcement of the NPI *myn libben* ‘my life’.

8.3.5. (Free) relative clauses

Het oyt Justiniaan ney liet, der m' yn t Rieugtbuwk kin fynne
what ever Justinian after let REL ARB in the law.book can find

‘Everything which Justinian bequaethed, which can be found in the book of law.’

(1746, *Gelokjouwing oon dy trogweyze, in brauwe Man Douwe Balck*, Jan Althuysen)

Mar min fynt s er næt heel tjuwk, Dy er oyt toa reytse, ...
but ARBfinds them there not very thick REL R ever to come

‘But not many are found, who ever set themselves to ...’

(1745b, *Gelokwisch oon Claas Lambsma, Doctir yn dy Wysebyjærte*, Jan Althuysen)

It can be observed that this writer uses the native relative pronoun *der*, but he also uses the Dutch system in which the demonstrative pronouns are used as relative pronouns. It should be further investigated what factors determine the writer’s choice of relative pronoun. The following example makes it clear that *oait* not only functions as a free choice item (‘whatever’), but that it may also enforce the interpretation of a universal quantifier (‘everything’):

Ja het Euclides oyt in het æk Wolf oyt zey.
yes what Euclid ever and what also Wolf ever said

‘Yes, everything Euclid and everything Wolf said also,’

Al het Natuirkund lært, der wit hy fin toa sprekken
al what physics learns R knows he of to speak

‘everything which physics teaches, he knows to talk about it.’

(1746, *Freugde Gyealp Op it ynheljen fin dy twaa brauwe Lieuw, Freerk Winter*, Jan Althuysen)

The coordination makes it clear that the two readings are not clearly distinguished.

8.3.6. Rhetorical clauses

Rhetorical clauses may display some remarkable additional phenomena. Consider the example below:

Wier krye wy sân man oyt ærnse wer fin dinne;
where get we such man ever anywhere again of thence

‘From where will we ever again get such a man?’

(1755, *Op it Droevig Ofstærren fin dy Brauwe, in Troggelærde Man*, Jan Althuysen)

Here the wh-phrase is construed with the complex postposition *fin dinne*, which is only found in the company of R-pronouns, but not with normal (non-R) NPs. What is remarkable is the presence of the

VP-internal adverbial *earne* ‘somewhere’, which functions as a modifier of the wh-phrase. Hence it is also possible to say, in ModF:

Wêr earne is er dan?
 where somewhere is he then
 ‘Where then?’

This shows that *earne* must be construed with the wh-phrase. It is unclear what the meaning contribution is of this modifier. Incidentally, the form *earne* belongs to written Frisian nowadays. It has been replaced by a loan from Dutch: *ergens*. This loan can be used equally well in the clause above. Another remarkable example is the following rhetorical clause containing *oait*:

Wa hat beljibbe noyt oyt za'n dey
 who has lived never ever such.a day
 ‘Who ever lived through such a day.’

(1766e *Veinten, vammen allegerre van Oerterper streek en veert*, B. Fabrycius)

Here the NPI has been reinforced by its antonym *never*, so the meaning of the combination is still ‘ever’.

8.4. Clause negation as a negative polarity item

In this example, clause negation is used as a negative polarity item when following the complementiser *foar* ‘before’:

ik hie fest for mij nimd, net wer nei jimmes te geæn, forstou net komd hieste!
 I had sure for me taken not again to you to go before.2SG not come had.2SG
 ‘I had made a strong decision not to visit you again, before you had come.’

(1779m26, *Aagtjellsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The complementiser *foar* ‘before’ is downward entailing, that is, it provides a negative (in some sense) environment in which negative polarity items may occur.

9. Topic, subject, agreement

9.1. The arbitrary pronoun *men*

9.1.1. Origin of the arbitrary pronoun

Men is a deficient pronoun in ModF (Slofstra & Hoekstra 2021).

- The subject form cannot be separated from the finite verb, to which it must be adjacent.
- It cannot be premodified

- It cannot be a member of a coordination
- It cannot be the head of a relative clause

Presumably, the same state of affairs obtained in older Frisian. It is generally supposed that arbitrary reference was expressed in Old Germanic by means of third person pro-drop, as evidenced by Old English and Old High German. The demise of pro-drop led to the necessity of lexicalising the (hitherto null) arbitrary pronoun. It was subsequently lexicalised as *man*. This pronoun underwent further developments in Frisian:

- It could not only occur with 3SG agreement on the verb, but also with 3PL agreement.
- It developed a paradigm comprising an object form and a possessive form.
- The object and possessive forms changed from third person to second person.

9.1.2. The arbitrary pronoun and plural agreement

Occasionally, the arbitrary pronoun is found with plural agreement on the verb (Krol 1985):

As it nu mey er tijd soe op in schieden gæen,
 if it now with the time would on the separating go
 ‘If it now would begin to be time to separate’

In as min oon e Loft de Sinne næt meer sæghen
 and as ARB on the sky the sun not more saw.3PL
 ‘and the sun was no longer to be seen in the sky’
 (1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

In libb'ne wonder-schillerij; Dij, az m' him tuwsen reys bijschoogje, Is altijd oors
 a living wonder-painting which if ARB'him thousand times consider.3PL is always different
 ‘A living wonderful painting which, if it is seen a thousand times, is always different’
 (~1640, *Tijd-kirttige praeterie twissche Egge en Wijnering*, in *Goodsfrioen*, Gysbert Japicx)

The use of a plural form only begins to appear in the 15th century, especially in *Snitser Recesboeken* 1490-1517 [Books of trials at Sneek] (Oosterhout 1960). Occasional instances of the arbitrary pronoun with a plural verb form are found sporadically up to the 20th century.

9.1.3. The two paradigms of the arbitrary pronoun

The arbitrary pronoun first emerged as a pronoun appearing as a nominative only in OF. In F^{17&18}, objective, reflexive and possessive forms of the pronoun appeared, yielding a full paradigm. However, there were two rival paradigms. The older one perhaps partly developed under the influence of Dutch, and the newer one seems to have been an indigenous innovation. The two rival

paradigms had the same form of the pronominal objective pronoun: *ien* 'one', which later developed into *jin* through the phonological process of breaking, by which a long vowel and a schwa changed into a glide and a short retracted vowel (on breaking, see Van der Meer 1985). The pronominal object form of the arbitrary pronoun will be cited in the running text in its ModF form, so *jin*, but it was originally homophonous to the quantifier *ien* 'one, somebody'. Two examples of its use are given below:

Objective (dative/accusative) pronominal usage of the arbitrary pronoun:

So me' immen det, al folle' yen so ney beschean schil
as ARB somebody does all much you so close happen shall
'As you treat others, so things shall happen to you.'
(~1640, *Friessche Tjerne: Psalm 137*, Gysbert Japicx)

Want it goed kostet ien folle jild.
for the stuff costs one much money
'Since things cost one a lot of money.'
(1701 *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

So the objective arbitrary pronoun doesn't change, except that it undergoes the phonological process of breaking. The reflexive arbitrary pronoun changes and so does the genitive form. So the old and the new system have distinct forms for the reflexive pronoun and the possessive pronoun.

Now the Dutch standard language adopted the designated reflexive *zich* from eastern dialects and from German. In contrast, Frisian, English and Dutch coastal dialects had lost this form. They just append 'self' to personal pronouns. Furthermore, inherent reflexives don't have the marker 'self'. Thus the following sentence is ambiguous throughout the history of Frisian:

<i>Hy wasket him.</i>	Compare Dutch:	<i>Hij wast zich.</i>
he washes him		he washes REF
'He washes him / himself.'		'He washes himself.'

Now, as the subject pronoun *men* developed a paradigm, the question arises what its object reflexive form would be like. As mentioned, two object reflexive forms came into existence. First, an example is given below of the old reflexive form, the one that probably developed first:

Old objective reflexive of the arbitrary pronoun:

<i>Naet dear-trog dat-me</i>	<i>him minglet onder</i>	<i>it kringjen fen greate heapen menschen</i>
not there-by that-ARB	REF mingles among	the pressing of great heaps people

‘Not by mingling oneself with the pressing of big heaps of people.’

(~1640, *Friessche Tjerne: Yen suwnerlinge forhânlinge*, Gysbert Japicx)

Dutch would use *zich* as the reflexive pronoun for the paradigm of the arbitrary pronoun *men*. The Frisian equivalent of *zich* is the 3SG pronoun *him* ‘him’, so the Frisian form may have developed as a loan translation from Dutch; or Frisian could have developed it on its own. However, there is an argument for considering this a loan translation from Dutch.

There is hard and fast generalisation across inherent reflexive forms in Frisian: the inherent reflexive is homophonous to the pronominal form. For example, *him* can mean both ‘him’ and ‘himself’. There is one exception to this generalisation: the arbitrary pronoun. Its old inherent reflexive form is *him*, and its pronominal counterpart is *ien* ‘one’. This exceptional behaviour strongly suggests that the use of *him* as the arbitrary reflexive for *men* is a Frisian loan translation, as the following table shows:

Table. *How Frisian created an inherent ARB reflexive as a loan from Dutch.*

	Reflexive for 3SG	ARB reflexive
Dutch	Hij wast <i>zich</i>	Men wast <i>zich</i>
Frisian	Hy waskes <i>him</i>	Men wasket => <i>him</i>
English translation	He washes himself	One washes oneself

This caused a unique situation to arise in the paradigm of personal pronouns which generally had homophony of non-reflexive and reflexive:

Table. *Why the ‘old’ ARB reflexive is the odd man out.*³

	Reflexive	Non-reflexive
1SG	Ik waskje <i>my</i>	Hy wasket <i>my</i>
2SG	Do waskest <i>dy</i>	Hy wasket <i>dy</i>
3SG	Hy wasket <i>him</i>	Do waskest <i>him</i>
3SG.FEM	Hja wasket <i>har</i>	Do waskest <i>har</i>
1PL	Wy waskje <i>ús</i>	Hja waskje <i>ús</i>
2PL	Jim waskje <i>jim</i>	Hja waskje <i>jim</i>
3PL	Hja waskje <i>har</i>	Jim waskje <i>har</i>
ARB	Men wasket <i>him</i>	Jim waskje <i>ien</i>

³ The examples in the table are given in ModF to illustrate the point which we want to make: the arbitrary reflexive was the odd man out in the objective reflexive and non-reflexive paradigm.

This observation explains both why *him* didn't survive as the reflexive counterpart to the arbitrary pronoun, and it also explains what happens next. One would expect that the arbitrary reflexive *him* would be ousted by its pronominal counterpart *ien*, bringing the last row of the table into line with the rest of the paradigm. This is indeed what happened.

New objective reflexive of the arbitrary pronoun:

<i>Soe-me</i>	<i>ien</i>	<i>neat</i>	<i>het</i>	<i>beriede motte?</i>
should-ARB	REF	not	somewhat	consider must'

'Shouldn't we first give this some thought?'

(1701, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

The example above also makes it clear that the Frisian arbitrary pronoun strongly tended to include the speaker, whereas its Dutch counterpart was exclusive. The possessive pronoun followed suit in this development. Examples are given below of the old and new possessive forms:

Old genitive of the arbitrary pronoun:

<i>Men lient</i>	<i>zijn frioun.</i>	<i>Men monnet</i>	<i>zijn fiyn.</i>
one lends	his friend	one admonishes	his enemy

'One lends to one's friend, one admonishes one's enemy.'

(1641 b731, *Fryske sprekwurden*, G. van Burmania)

New genitive of the arbitrary pronoun:

<i>Zyog Frieon</i>	<i>al mey-er tyed</i>	<i>zoa</i>	<i>wurd-me</i>	<i>âd,</i>
see friend	so with-the time	so	becomes-ARB	old

<i>in gryez.</i>	<i>As dan jens libbens tyed</i>	<i>ney d'eynpæl</i>	<i>komt toa roljen, ...</i>
and grey	if then one's life's time	to the finish	comes to roll

'See, friend, one becomes old and grey with time. If one's lifetime approaches its limit, ...'

(1755, *Freugde Gyealp Op dy Zulvere Brulloft Fin dy Heer Japik Tiboel*, Simon Althuysen)

Concerning the arbitrary pronoun in ModF, see Jarich Hoekstra (2010).

9.2. Dropping a subject topic

Demonstrative pronouns are used in Modern Frisian, Dutch and German as topic pronouns to refer to discourse topics. In older Frisian, such a demonstrative pronoun could be dropped:

ik ron strax ney hous in sey t ous Heyte datt er 4 Schoodatin wesse hiene,
 I walked just to home and said it our dad that there 4 soldiers been had
 ‘I just walked home and told out father that there had been four soldiers’

in – hien my de brune Kedde ontnimd
 and DEM had me the brown horse taken
 ‘and they had taken the brown horse from me.’

(1701c66, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

dy giet naernse op wt as mey slimme en listige grepen oorljoe fouckin te fandljen ...
 DEM goes R.nothing on out as with bad and cunning tricks other’s fish.traps to collect
 ‘He has no other goal than to collect other people’s fish traps through mean and cunning tricks ...’

wolle se ontsleyn wesse, soo motte se al heel ney zijn pijpen donsie;
 want they exempted be then must they all whole to his pipes dance
 ‘if they want to be exempted from this, then they have to dance entirely to his tune’

in – ontsioucht nimmin neat, al wieren t æck sijn beste frionnen
 and DEM spare nobody not if were it even his best friends
 ‘and he doesn’t spare anybody at all, not even if they were his best friends’

(1701c58, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

In ModF, the demonstrative pronoun *dy* ‘those > they’ would have to be inserted in the position of the dash.

9.3. Reduction of unstressed clitic pronouns

The clitic pronoun *se* /zə/ (‘she, they, her, them’) could be reduced to /əs/ in phonological contexts in which nowadays it would have the form /zə/.

Soo te libjen binn-es sed
 so to live are-they fed.up
 ‘They are fed up with living like that.’

(1701c80, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

Ja binn-is fen dat volck?
 yes are-they of that people
 ‘Yes, are they that kind of people?’

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

One might perhaps see a metathesis process at work here, in which -ESE/-ES and -SE become confused with one another. J. Hoekstra (2008) shows that this is at least the case for a class of metathesis processes in Frisian involving sonorants, specifically /l, r, n/. Now /s/ is, of course, not a sonorant, but it links up with /l,r,n/ as the natural class of alveolar continuants.

9.4. Discourse pro-drop?

In the following example, the 1PL personal subject pronoun is omitted under coreference with the arbitrary pronoun:

Min mei wol roúwje om tijge Ljeúw; (Wa zoe 't om zokken Man net spijte;)
 ARB may.3SG DcP mourn for good people who would it for such.a man not lament
 'We may surely mourn good people (Who wouldn't lament such a man?)'

Mar _ onderwerpje úis God, en bljeúw, Az Christen-Minschen past, bijtroúwjen,
 but submit us God and continue as Christen-people befits trust
 'but submit ourselves to God and continue, as ios fitting for Christian people, to trust

Op him dij 't alles nimt en jóúwt:
 on him who it all takes and gives
 'Him who takes it all and gives it all.'

(1780c, *Ien twagesprek oer ... dij Wol Edele Heer Eize de Wint*, Eelke Meinerts)

The semantic content of the missing 1PL pronoun can be recovered from the previously used arbitrary pronoun, which after all includes the speaker and can thus count semantically as a first-person plural. Note that the arbitrary pronoun cannot count syntactically as a plural pronoun, since the accompanying verb is 3SG (unless the schwa is omitted). Note the writer is directly addressing the reader here (since he is preaching), which means the semantic content of the pronoun can be retrieved from the context through deixis.

10. The verb

10.1. Copula of body position

There are four copulas of body position which all imply the copula of being. These are in ModF: *sitte* 'sit', *lizze* 'lie', *stean* 'stand', *hingje* 'hang'. In ModF, these copulas of body position are used for persons and things:

<i>De flesse stiet op tafel.</i>	<i>It kleed leit op tafel.</i>
the bottle stands on table	the cloth lies on table
'The bottle is (standing) on the table.'	'The cloth is (lying) on the table.'

<i>De wyn</i>	<i>sit</i>	<i>yn de flesse.</i>	<i>De wask</i>	<i>hinget oan 'e line.</i>
the wine	sits	in the bottle	the laundry	hangs on the line
'The wine is in the bottle.'			'The laundry is (hanging) on the line.'	

ModE tends to use the copula of being here, not a copula of body position. Older Frisian just like English is more sparing in its use of verbs of body position than ModF and ModD. Some examples are given below:

<i>nu lesten</i>	<i>triewden se him ien stick Pik in 't Bird / ... /</i>	<i>do wier t bird oon sijn Himd fest</i>
now recently	put they him a piece tar in the beard	then was the beard to his shirt stuck
'Now recently they put a piece of tar in his beard. ... Then his beard stuck to his shirt.'		
(1701c44, <i>Waatzje Gribberts' Brulloft</i>)		

<i>jæ zil hier wol</i>	<i>hette ôon ha: zil op it minst</i>	<i>ien wijke zegn zân ôon fest wesse;</i>
they will this.R DcP	what to have shall at the least	a week six seven to annexed be
'They shall have quite some work from this. It shall take at least some six, seven weeks.'		
(1779m28, <i>Aagtje IJsbrants, Eelke Meinerts</i>)		

ModF would use the verb of body position *sitte* 'sit' here. The examples regularly involve the adjective, used as a verb modifier, *fest* 'annex, stuck'. The following example doesn't involve this word:

<i>Folle fouten wierne</i>	<i>ijn 't oôr</i>	<i>boette mijn schuld;</i>	<i>doz wit ik wol</i>
many mistakes were	in the other	outside my fault	thus know I DcP
'There were many mistakes in the rest which were not my fault. But I know'			
<i>dat tro mijn sleæuwigheit</i>	<i>in dommens</i>	<i>er folle</i>	<i>in wierne.</i>
that through my carelessness	and stupidity	it.R many	in were
'that due to my carelessness and stupidity, there were many in it.'			
(1777llw, <i>In wurdje oan de lêzer, E. Meinerts</i>)			

The examples all involve examples in which ModF would use the copula *sitte* 'sit'. Hence this copula has extended its scope.

10.2. The copula of being used for doing

In the following example, the copula of being is used with the meaning of the verb of doing:

<i>Het biste</i>	<i>raar,</i>	<i>Aagtje.</i>
what are.2SG	strange	Aagtje

‘How strange are you acting, Aagtje?’
(1779m25, *Aagtje IJsbrents*, Eelke Meinerts)

Thus the verb of being was in wider semantic use than it is nowadays.

10.3. The finite verb 2SG and the schwa

In older Frisian, the 2nd-person singular verb form always has a schwa, spelled as -e. However, Modern Frisian usually lacks this schwa. Furthermore, in Modern Frisian, the schwa is acceptable if it can be interpreted as the weak pronoun *do* > *de* > *te* > *e*, but it sounds ungrammatical (marked by *) or old-fashioned (marked by #) if it just functions as a verb ending. This describes the following judgments from ModF:

# <i>Hy tinkt</i>	<i>datst gauris</i>	<i>nei hûs ta rinste</i>	(-e is agreement ending)
he thinks	that.2SG DcP	to home walk.2SG	
* <i>Hy tinkt</i>	<i>datst gauris</i>	<i>nei hûs ta rinsto</i>	(-o is a pronoun)
he thinks	that.2SG DcP	to home walk.you	
<i>Hy tinkt</i>	<i>datste gauris</i>	<i>nei hûs ta rinst</i>	(-e is swakke foarm fan foarnamwurd do)
he thinks	that.you DcP	to home walk.you	

In instances like the one above, the schwa in -ste as a verb ending is old-fashioned, as indicated by the "#", whereas it is acceptable as a weak form of *do* ('you'). These examples all involve embedded clauses.

Let us now turn to main clauses. If the schwa in the main clause can be interpreted as a weak form of *do*, then the sentence is likewise acceptable:

<i>Rinste dan nei hûs ta?</i>	(weak pronoun)
<i>Rinsto dan nei hûs ta?</i>	(strong pronoun)

In main clauses with a pre-verbal subject, the schwa can only be interpreted as a verb ending. Unexpectedly, -ste is not merely old-fashioned but actually ungrammatical in main clauses (see De Haan 1997, specifically pp. 62-65; Hoekema 1989; E. Hoekstra 1994). The fact that -ste is ungrammatical rather than old-fashioned is surprising. It could indicate that -ste as a verb ending persists only in subordinate clauses—meaning it has become construction-specific. Omitting the subject does not alter the pattern of facts, as shown below:

- ?* *Do rinste mar nei hûs ta!*
* *Rinste mar nei hûs ta!*

Rinst mar nei hûs ta!

Omitting the preceding subject *do* was likely never possible in older Frisian, which used only *-ste*. It appears that the loss of the schwa in the verb ending coincided with the emergence of the option to omit a preceding *do* (hypothesis). The complex patterns of usage found in Modern Frisian and discussed here do not occur in Frisian^{17&18}, as the form used there is consistently *-ste*.

10.4. Complementiser agreement

ModF has complementiser agreement for the 2SG (De Haan 1997 / 2010). Old Frisian didn't have complementiser agreement for the 2SG, but it is well recorded for F^{17&18} (Merkuur 2012). The following example illustrates its absence in Old Frisian:

That thu nenes thinges jaria ne salt
that you no thing covet NEG shall

'That you won't covet any thing.'

(Codex Unia, 10 Commandments)

In F^{17&18}, there are many examples of 2SG complementiser agreement, two of which are given below:

datstu mijn ade beloften allegerre so nauw onthaden heste
that.2SG.you my old promises all so precisely remembered have.2SG

'that you have so precisely remembered all my old promises'

(1701c56, *Waatze Gribberts' Brulloft*)

datste dat allegerre weer ophelje wotte
that.2SG that all again up.rake want.2SG

'that you want to rake up all that stuff again'

(1701c56, *Waatze Gribberts' Brulloft*)

It can also be observed that the 2SG form of the present tense modals still have the ending of the past tense, thus ending in *-te*, since the present tense modals originally derive from past tense forms.

In ModF, the ending has been regularised to the present tense 2SG ending of other verbs, that is *-st(e)*.

10.5. The imperative

In older Frisian, the imperative form of verbs sometimes ends in *-e*:

Nu: farre wol, in blieuw sôn
now go well and stay sound

‘Now farewell, and stay sound.’

(1701, *Waatze Gribberts’ Brulloft*, Wassenbergh, 97)

Nu nu / druge dijn ægen

now now dry your.SG eyes

‘There, there, dry your eyes.’

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

Maer Mem / hercke my reys

but mother listen me DcP

‘But mother, please listen to me.’

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

However, forms without schwa may also be found. In the case of the imperative of *harkje* ‘listen’, the forms ending in schwa are generally slightly older than those without the schwa, though this intuition should be backed up by corpus study. Forms in schwa can be found both with ordinary weak verbs and with *je*-verbs. The following example is not a *je*-verb:

Wol tiæne din te wirck, lit ws næt lang oon-drockje

DcP go then to work let us not long press

‘Well, go to work then, let us not be long about it’

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

Clearly, the role of the schwa in the imperative needs to be further investigated.

10.6. The verb of going: semantic restriction when selecting a gerundial infinitive

In Modern Frisian, the verb *gean* ‘to go’ can take a gerundial infinitive (so in -n), but not an ordinary infinitive (in -e). The infinitive is semantically restricted to the four verbs of body position: *sitte* ‘sit’, *lizze* ‘lie’, *stean* ‘stand’, *hingje* ‘hang’. The period from 1600 to 1800 is marked by a great deal of interference, because little was written in Frisian so the Dutch writing language exerted heavy pressures on novices writing in Frisian. The Dutch usage of *gaan* as an auxiliary has been encroaching upon the periphery of Frisian for a very long time. The following clauses illustrate that the selected infinitive must be gerundial in ModF:

Ik gean sitten / op bêd lizzen

I go sit.GI on bed lie.GI

** Ik gean sitte / op bêd lizze*

I go sit.OI on bed lie.OI

The following clause negatively illustrates the semantic restriction to verbs of body position:

* *Ik gean in boek skriuwen / skriuwe*

I go a book write.GI / write.OI

‘I go write a book.’

In older Frisian, the situation is comparable to that in ModF described above. A quick survey of *gean* (to go) used as an auxiliary verb reveals that reliable sources of authentic Frisian (Gysbert Japicx, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*, Eelke Meinerts) strictly adhere to the semantic rule that applies to Modern Frisian as well. In contrast, violations of this semantic rule characteristically appear in occasional texts where the likelihood of interference is greater since the authors are novices at writing Frisian:

In noe stioert er mie nay ien tscoeinder to, der giet er mie may plagien

and now sends he me to a witch to R.it goes he me with bother

‘And now he sends me to a witch, he will bother me with that.’

(1661b, *Klucht van de bedrogen smith*, Jacobus Kemp)

Der kaam æk Spook om hem te quellen /

there came also a ghost for him to torture.GI

‘There also came a ghost to torture him’

Der hem sijn libben ging vertellen:

REL him his life went tell.GI

‘which went on to tell him his life’

(1709b, *En oor op 't Friesk*, R[inse] W[obbess])

On the whole, these verb violate the semantic selectional requirements of the verb of going, but they do exhibit the gerundial infinitive. In ModF, such violations also occur due to unbalanced bilingualism under the influence of Dutch, as they did in F^{17&18} (on ModF, see Coret-Bergstra 2020, also Bergsma & Hoekstra 2022).

It is striking that we find neither incorrect nor correct examples of *gean* + infinitive in the work of Gysbert Japicx. GJ has only a single example involving the verb of going selecting a prepositional verbal construction:

Er'n da uwz Gritman stoar, ho ging it op in suwppjen.

then when our magistrate died how went it on a drinking

‘On that occasion, when our magistrate died, there was a big drinking bout.’

(~1640, *Friessche Tjerne*, Gysbert Japicx)

This is a perfect construction in ModF and, apparently, in older Frisian as well.

10.7. The auxiliary of the perfect: to have or to be

10.7.1. For verbs of movement and change

Certain verbs of movement and change could appear with *hawwe* ('have') in the perfect tense where we would nowadays use *wêze* ('be'):

om net ta fortjen, eer hij bij Fijsscaal komd hie
for not to away.go before he at Fijsscaal come had
'to not go away before he had arrived at Fijsscaal's place'

(1779m28, *Aagtje Ijsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

soen y my dir om slaan? Off ick al booske hie?
would you me R.it for hit if I already married had
'Would you hit me if I had already married?'

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

It appears that the phenomenon shows up especially in the past tense. This is even true in ModF in which it may show up in past tense counterfactuals:

Hied er mar op tiid kommen!
Had he only on time come
'If only he had been on time!'

However, the class of sentences in which the past tense of the verb of having was used as the auxiliary of the perfect was defined somewhat more broadly than it is today. Thus, in F^{17&18}, we also find examples using the present tense:

hoo hett et dy al gien yn e Sted?
how has it you DcP gone in the town
'How did you go with you in the town?'

(1701c40, *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

in hoe folle (fen dy jinge dy 'er al op begoast habbe) jiette weer oerbeek riggelje
and how many of those who R.it DcP on begun have yet again back fall
'And how many of those who began on this road, yet again fall away from it.'

(~1640, *Friessche Tjerne: In sûnerlinge ferhanneling*, Gysbert Japicx)

All in all, it seems that older Frisian showed a tendency to use the verb of having as the auxiliary of the perfect where nowadays the verb of being is used.

10.7.2. For the verb of being

In Old Frisian, the verb of being could be conjugated both with itself and with the verb of having (Johnston 1994:14, translated): “Of the 387 instances of the perfect construction with *wesa* that I have found in Old Frisian, 87% (n=336) have *habba* and 13% (n=51) have *wesa* as the auxiliary verb. ... As Popkema (1984:195) already noted, the auxiliary verb *wesa* does not appear on the scene until 1450. All in all, *wesa* occurs in only 2% of instances of the construction in the material from before 1500, and in 35% of instances from after 1550.” For the period 1600-1800, Johnston found the following (translated): “In the 230 instances of the perfect construction in Middle Frisian known to me, *habbe* ‘have’ appears as the auxiliary verb 162 times (71%) and *wezze* ‘be’ 68 times (29%).” This development shows that the verb of being came to be more and more used as the auxiliary of the perfect for itself, possibly under the influence of Dutch.

10.8. Some idioms with to be

There are some characteristic idioms with the verb of being. A construction which is impersonal nowadays, that is, having *it* as the subject, could have a personal subject in older Frisian:

je het mennigmiel west, dat ze nin jild omme hannen hie.
she has often.times been that she no money about.the hands had
'It often happened that she had no money on her hands.'
(1779m20, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

In Modern Frisian, we would use *it* as the subject and realize the personal argument as an object, as in the first sentence, or choose a construction that does not realize the personal argument in the main clause, as in the last two sentences:

It is har faak bard dat se gjin jild om hannen hie.
it is her often happened that she no jild about hands had
It hat faak sa west dat se gjin jild om hannen hie.
it is her so been that she no jild about hands had

It is even possible in ModF to use the verb of having with a personal subject:

Hja hat it gauris hân dat se gjin jild om hannen hie.
she has it often had that she no money about hands had

Alternations of to have and to be are well-known from the languages of the world and Frisian is no exception. Another interesting idiom is the following. The verb *wêze* ('to be') could be used with an

argument expressed as a noun phrase, whereas nowadays we use a prepositional phrase formed with the preposition *mei* ‘with’ or a different verb:

Het is dy Goudin Bern?

what is you golden child

‘What is wrong with you, golden child?’

(1639b, *Ansck en Houck*, Johan van Hichtum)

Nowadays, the object would be expressed in a PP built on the preposition *mei* ‘with’. Perhaps this goes back to the time when the instrumental case was merged with the dative.

10.9. Verb order in the verb group

In 17th and 18th century Frisian, the order within the verb cluster appears at first blush to be free, but this is not quite the case. Upon close inspection, the head-initial word order (possible in Dutch) appears mainly in Interference Frisian and in poetry. In Interference Frisian, it is found under the influence of Dutch in unbalanced bilinguals. In poetry, it appears under the influence of the Dutch writing tradition. As is well-known, people used to write Dutch are heavily influenced by Dutch when writing a bit of Frisian. However, the vulgar comedy *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft* ‘the wedding of Waatze Gribberts’ (1701) is an excellent sample of spoken Frisian. Interestingly, it consequently has the head-final word order: the main verb precedes the auxiliary verb. Similarly Gysbert Japicx has a good reputation as a Frisian writer, writing complex baroque poetry in ‘correct’ Frisian. His poetry shows a high degree of head-initial word order in the verb group, but in his prose it dwindles to a low percentage, and the relevant head-initial examples show the influence of Dutch idiomatically as well (Hoekstra 2010). See also section 10.12.

10.10. The expression of irrealis or subjunctive mood, the A and B constructions

Nowadays, the past tense of *sille* ‘shall’ is primarily used to express the irrealis. In older Frisian, the past tense of other modal auxiliary verbs could also be used for this purpose:

woe ik net helte leæver ien fatzoenlijk Minske het jaan!

would I not half rather a decent person what give

‘Shouldn’t I much rather want to give something to a decent person?’

(1779m07, *Aagtje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

This relates to the so-called B-construction uncovered and described by Jarich Hoekstra for 19th century Frisian (1990/1997). Jarich Hoekstra points out that three verb constructions with the auxiliary of the perfect and a modal may have two forms:

- (1) Dutch type: finite aux of the perfect + modal verb + infinitival main verb:

Dutch: *had kunnen komen* 'had could come>could have come'

Frisian: *hie komme kind*

- (2) English type: finite modal + infinitival auxiliary of the perfect + perfect participle

Frisian: *koe kommen hawwe* 'could have come'

So the difference between A and B is whether the modal is realised as the finite verb (B construction) or whether the auxiliary of the perfect is realised as the finite verb (A construction).

Now, I cannot go into this subject here for reasons of time, but the behaviour of the B-construction, the English type, should really be investigated for F^{17&18}. The B-construction may be found in Dutch, but it is very much restricted in semantic scope to something like counterfactual possibilities. In 19th century Frisian, as Jarich Hoekstra's data show, the B-construction has a much wider semantic scope and it competes with the A-construction. Many examples of the B-construction of 19th century Frisian come out as A-constructions in ModF. This section, like many others, may be considered to be an invitation to expansion.

Furthermore, the verb *sille* 'shall' may show a mixed word order in older Frisian when functioning as the finite verb for a group of three verbs. An example is given below:

<i>dear-yn wy</i>	<i>fen alle storm-twierren</i>	<i>befrye sille wurde</i>
R.REL-in we	of all storm-blasts	freed shall become

'in which we shall be set free from all storm blasts'

(~1640, *Yen suwnerlinge forhânlinge*, Gysbert Japicx)

This phenomenon is systematically found in older Frisian.

10.11. The verb of continuation: semantic restriction and gerundial infinitive

In Modern Frisian, the verb *bliuwe* 'to remain/stay' can take a gerundial infinitive in -n, but not an ordinary infinitive in -e. The infinitive is semantically restricted to the four verbs of body position: *sitte* 'sit', *lizze* 'lie', *stean* 'stand', *hingje* 'hang'. The usage of *bliuwe* 'stay' between 1600 and 1800 is just like that in Modern Frisian. An example is given below:

<i>Dan maste</i>	<i>net</i>	<i>ynn e Krollen</i>	<i>fin zyn Hier</i>	<i>hingjen</i>	<i>blieuwe</i>
then must.2SG	not	in the curls	of his hair	hang.Gl	stay

'Then you shouldn't stay entangled in the curls of his hair.'

(1779c, *Het/ Jonge Lieuws/ Boosk*, Eelke Meinerts)

There are only a few exceptions, and in those instances, a Dutch or even *Stêdsk* (Urban Frisian) context is clearly evident. Unlike with the verb of going, we find little interference from Dutch here. The question arises as to why interference effects occur with the verb of going, but not with the verb of continuation. One might hypothesize (as a research question) that Dutch *blijven* was used with the same semantic restriction at that time as its Frisian counterpart. Another research question is whether there is a link to the fact that the phonological distance between *gaan* and *gean* is smaller than that between *blijven* and *bliuwe*. A third research question is whether frequency plays a role, given that the verb of going is much more frequent than the verb of continuation. Furthermore, if the Dutch usage is less hampered by semantic restrictions, then its usage will be more frequent than its Frisian counterpart, which could be of relevance.

10.12. The verb of doing as a causative auxiliary

The normal auxiliary of causation is *litte* 'let', both in ModF and in older Frisian. However, written Dutch prominently featured the verb of doing as well as a causative auxiliary. This use also entered written Frisian. There are three markers that this causative use of *dwaan* 'do' is an interference:

- Many examples come from the Bible translations of Japicx and Althuysen, betraying the influence of the Dutch Bible translation.
- The accompanying word order in the verb group is often head-initial, as in Dutch.
- This use of the verb of doing may be accompanied by a uniquely Dutch phenomenon, *Infinitivus-Pro-Participio* (IPP), which is not present in spoken Frisian.

To illustrate, consider the following example:

*Want as ienigh Prince , mei'ertyd immen so hæg **het dwaen klieuwen***

for if any prince, with the time somebody so high has do-INF climb.Gl

'For if any prince has let somebody climb so high as time goes by'

(~1640, *Friessche Tjerne: In sûnerlinge ferhanneling*, Gysbert Japicx)

The word order is head-initial, which is not native to Frisian. Second, the verb of doing appears in its infinitival form, rather than as a past participle, so it displays the Dutch phenomenon of IPP.

Furthermore, the prose writings of Gysbert Japicx neatly have a head-final order in the verb group (Hoekstra 2012). But when he uses the causative verb of doing, an interference, this causes a head-initial word order in the verb group:

dy ... naet oorz syyckje den stuwne , uwre in for-fâlle om him to oerstjolphjen,

who not else search as time, hour and occasion for him to overcome

'Who seek nothing else than time, hour and occasion to overcome him'

in yn alle boazheite *to dwaen om-rôaljen* .

and in all evils do make wallow

‘and to make him wallow in all evils’

(~1640, *Friessche Tjerne: In sûnerlinge ferhanneling*, Gysbert Japicx)

Thus the Dutch lexical interference in the verb of causation correlates with increased use of head-initial order, another interference. Some more examples of IPP and head-initial word order in the verb group are given below, and they are restricted to this verb:

Y hien uwz yn dy tiesselnetten *Dwaan* *kommen* *trog Jens sterke hân*

and had us in the tangle.nets make.INF come.GI through Your strong hand

‘and had made us to come in the entangling nets through Your strong hand’

(1755r066, *Friesche/ Rymlery/ Yn Twaa Dielen bystænde: Psalm 66*, Jan Althuysen)

Myn grætte yver *het my dwaan* *for gæn*,

my great zeal has me do.INF perish

‘My great zeal has eaten me up’

(1755r119, *Friesche/ Rymlery/ Yn Twaa Dielen bystænde: Psalm 119*, Jan Althuysen))

The construction using the verb of doing as a causative verb was adopted wholesale from the Dutch written language and imported into Frisian. While the verb of doing itself existed in Frisian (*dwaan*), structural features such as IPP (Infinitivus Pro Participio) and word order were not consistently adapted. It is essentially Dutch in Frisian clothing. The takeaway is, once again, that Dutch and Frisian are interconnected for bilingual speakers. The question arises, of course, as to why there was such a need for this construction in Frisian. Why was it borrowed? In any case, there was no Frisian equivalent—that is, no etymologically related word that facilitated the same causative construction but with Frisian word order and without IPP. Naturally, the meaning could be expressed in other ways, but that is precisely where interference is likely to occur. Compare this with modal auxiliary verbs, where such interference did not manifest—most likely because there are existing equivalents that are both etymologically and structurally related.

11. Word formation and morphology

11.1. The adjectival suffixes *-lik* and *-ich*

The suffix *-lik* is used less frequently in Mod F than in older Frisian. In its place, we find other suffixes such as *-ich*, compare *restlyck* with ModF *rêstich*. The meaning has also changed:

T is restlyck mej hel fel sliepen to gaen.

it is restful with whole skin sleep to go

‘It is soothing to go to sleep with one’s skin intact.’

(1614 b1065, *Fryske sprekwurden*, G. van Burmania)

In the sentence above, *restlyck* means “it gives one peace, a sense in which we cannot use *rêstich* in Modern Frisian. This indicates that it was not merely the suffix that was replaced; rather, the word *restlyck* was entirely supplanted by another word, *rêstich*, which possesses a different, though overlapping, semantic range. For information on when *-lijk* constructions in Dutch fell into decline, see Hüning and Van Santen (1994). They argue that the majority of *-lijk* derivatives in Dutch were replaced by those ending in *-baar* when the *-lijk* derivative referred to the object of a verb.

11.2. The verbal prefixes *be-* and *fer-*

In some cases, the prefix *be-* has been displaced by *fer-*, in all likelihood through lexical replacement of the word as a whole:

dou maste mij net bijklappe

you must.2SG me not on.tell

‘You must not tell on me.’

(1779m27, *Aagtje IIsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

A similar alternation is also found for: *betrouwe* and *fertrouwe* ‘trust’. On verbs prefixed with *be-* in Frisian, see Veenstra (1988).

11.3. The suffixes *te-* and *fer-*

The prefix *te-* has gradually become less productive, though it persisted longer in Frisian than in Dutch (Tamminga 1973a: 90-93, 1973b; Hüning 1997; J. Hoekstra 2003:1998). Nowadays, it is obsolete or highly literary. In older Frisian, we even encounter it in the colloquial speech of a farce

o Hoonne! ljeave Hoonne, soo sille se dy toploytse in toschourre, ...

o rooster dear rooster so shall they you pluck and tear

‘O rooster, dear rooster, then they shall pluck and tear you’

‘t is lijckewol schæ datt er soo tofretten wirde zil

it is however damage that he so devoured become shall

‘but it is a pity that he will be devoured in this way’

(1701c32 *Waatze Gribberts Brulloft*)

Thus the prefix *te-* was common in F^{17&18}.

11.4. Compound of adjective and noun

Modern Frisian still features adjective-noun combinations that lack a schwa. The phenomenon may have originated at a time when zero-inflection of an adjective was possible after an indefinite article with a non-neuter noun. These combinations carry the stress on the second element. Examples from modern Frisian are (J. Hoekstra 2000:122-123):

<i>Goedfreed</i>	<i>blaumoandei</i>	<i>reahûn</i>
Good Friday	blue.Monday 'one or two Mondays'	red.dog 'rubella'

Dutch often uses the same idioms here, but with schwa inflection:

<i>Goede Vrijdag</i>	<i>blauwe maandag</i>	<i>rode hond</i>
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11.5. Nominal compounds of which the first member wavers between noun and verb

Older Frisian has the compound *stankfet* 'stink barrel' (1701c08), a noun-noun compound. ModF would prefer a V-N compound based on the verb *stjonke* 'stink', so: *stjonkfet* 'stink barrel'. The same noun/verb competition is found in nominal compounds of which the first member means 'milk'. This can either be the noun *molke*, or the verb stem *melk*, homophonous to the Dutch noun *melk*. Thus we find in ModF both *melkamer* and *molkamer* 'milk bucket'.

11.6. Nominal compounds with an irregular plural as first member

In F^{17&18}, the word *goes* 'goose' had the plural form *gees* 'geese', like in English. It is interesting, then, to see which form is used in compound words. It turns out that the singular form followed by a schwa appears in the compound: *guse boncken* (Ansck in Houck). The WFT only records *guozzen* for the later centuries, so somewhere around 1800 plural *gees* must have been superseded by plural *guozzen*.

The form *schiepintzyies* 'sheep cheese' appears in the same source; compare *sûpenbrij* 'buttermilk porridge' and **swietmolkentsiis** in Modern Frisian. The spelling of the letter -n- in a compound looks un-Frisian, since compounds generally just have a schwa (or an -s). Early Modern Frisian has 13 instances of compounds involving *skieppe*- (sheep-), and only the aforementioned example contains an 'n'. This supports the idea that this is a case of interference.

11.7. Irregular verbs

The ModF verb *gisse* 'guess' had an irregular past:

Wel ja, dat gies ik wol. 'well yes, I guessed that'.
(1779m26, *Aagje IJsbrants*, Eelke Meinerts)

The verb *komme* appears as an infinitive in -je: *komje* (1778g, *De Prins kaam ta Boetenpost*). There are more verbs in schwa which appear as -je verbs in older Frisian and vice versa.



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